NexKit
GLOBAL

ETHIOPIA EDITION
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THE PHONE-FIRST EDITION

03

The AI Income System

How to Sell Useful Services With Free AI Tools, Without Building Software

Turn free AI tools into real client services, with the quality control that keeps clients.

12 sellable services | 40+ prompts | Quality-control system

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The AI Income System

How to Sell Useful Services With Free AI Tools, Without Building Software

EDITION AND PUBLISHER

Copyright, scope and disclaimer

First Edition · September 2026
Published by the **NexKit your country Editorial Team**.
AI Income for locals — How to Use Free AI Tools to Sell Useful Services Without Building Software.

What this course is

A practical, tool-agnostic guide to selling ordinary services with the help of a free AI chat tool. It teaches one repeatable production workflow — **brief, prompt, draft, verify, edit, deliver** — and applies that workflow to twelve services that small small local businesses, online sellers and organisers already pay people to do.

Everything here is text-first and built for a phone with a modest data bundle. All prices are where you liven dollars and marked as examples. All prompts are copy-ready. No software needs to be installed and no money needs to be spent to begin.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of income. It is not a software engineering course, an advertising course or an investment course. It does not teach you to build an application, run paid ad campaigns, trade, or invest money.

Nothing in these pages guarantees a client, a sale, a reply to a message or any monthly figure. A free AI tool is treated throughout as a **productivity tool** that shortens the first draft — never as a machine that produces money on its own.

DISCLAIMER

This course is **educational only**. It does not provide financial, legal, tax or investment advice, and it creates no professional relationship of any kind.

There is **no income guarantee** here, express or implied. Results depend on your effort, your market, your writing, your follow-up and conditions outside anyone's control.

All businesses, clients, prices and documents used as examples are **illustrative and fictional**, and are labelled as such in the text.

You are responsible for complying with **local law**, your **tax obligations**, the **rules of any platform you use**, and the **requirements of any payment provider** you receive money through. Where a legal, tax or regulatory question affects you, confirm the current position with the responsible local authority or a qualified professional before you act.

FIGURES IN THIS COURSE

Last updated: September 2026. Every figure, fee, limit, price and statistic quoted in this course is current **as of September 2026** and carries a source URL in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the end of the book.

Prices, payment limits, free-tier allowances, platform rules and taxes change — sometimes within a single year. Where a number matters to a decision you are about to make, re-check it at the source before you rely on it. Free plans in particular change often: verify the current free limits before you build a workflow on any tool.

SUPPORT

Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

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HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.

BEFORE YOU START

Before You Start

This course teaches one thing properly: how to use a free AI chat tool as a productivity tool, and how to sell the work that comes out of it without damaging your name or the client's business.

If you have ever typed a question into a free AI chat tool, read the answer, thought "that is not quite right", and closed the tab, you already know both halves of this course. The tool is genuinely useful. The tool is also confidently wrong in ways that are hard to spot. The whole job is learning to sit between those two facts.

What this course can help with

Choosing a service that local clients already pay for. Running a repeatable six-stage workflow: **brief, prompt, draft, verify, edit, deliver**. Writing prompts that produce usable drafts instead of vague essays. Catching invented facts before a client does. Pricing, packaging, finding buyers, sending outreach, collecting payment.

What this course cannot do

It cannot guarantee you a client, a reply, a sale or a monthly figure. It cannot make a free AI tool accurate. It cannot replace your judgement about a real business. It cannot tell you what any tool will do next month — free plans change, and the change is rarely announced in advance.

What you actually need

— **A phone is genuinely enough to start.** Captions, product descriptions, CV work, FAQ sheets, SMS copy and short research notes can all be produced on an Android phone with a browser and a notes app.

— **A laptop makes long documents easier.** Formatting a 30-page report, building a slide outline, or managing a spreadsheet of 30 prospects is faster with a keyboard and a wider screen. If you do not own one, a friend's laptop for two hours a week, or a cheap internet-café session, covers most of it.

— **A free AI chat tool.** Any one that offers a free tier. Availability and free limits may vary by country and account, so verify before you rely on it. You do not need to pay for anything to complete this course.

— **A notes app and a spreadsheet.** Google Sheets on a phone browser works. So does a paper notebook for the first two weeks.

— **A modest data bundle.** The workflows here are text-first. A 2 GB monthly bundle is around $0.60 and is enough for the reading and writing parts of this course. Avoid using your bundle on video.

How much time this takes

8–10	14	1
HOURS OF READING AND PRACTICE	DAYS IN THE PLAN	SERVICE TO START WITH

Spread that over two weeks. Read one section, do the exercise in it, then move on. A reader who finishes this book in one sitting and does nothing will earn nothing — not because the material failed, but because no service was ever delivered to anyone.

> **THE HONEST STARTING POSITION**

You are not building a software company. You are learning to produce a small, useful, verified piece of work faster than you could alone, and to charge a fair price for it. That is a real skill, it is sellable in every local city, and it does not require a licence, an office or a laptop.

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Never send raw AI output to a client. Not once. Not as a first draft. Not as a "rough idea". Not as a test.

Everything a free AI chat tool produces is a starting point that has not been checked by anyone. It may contain a wrong price, an invented statistic, a fake source, a real competitor's name, a policy the client cannot honour, or a sentence in the local language that no local would write. It arrives instantly, which makes it feel finished. It is not finished.

Your work begins where the tool stops: verify every fact, rewrite every generic line, remove what the client cannot deliver, and put your own name on something you are willing to defend. That gap between the draft and the deliverable **is the service you are selling**. Remove the gap and you have nothing to sell.

FIT

Who this is for — and who it is not for

This is for you if

- You are 18–35, in your city or in a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a smaller town, a smaller town, a smaller town, a smaller town, a smaller town or Debre Birhan.
- You have used a free AI chat tool a few times and suspect there is money in it.
- Your English is good but not native, and you can write a clear paragraph.
- You can give this 45–60 minutes a day for two weeks.
- You are willing to send messages to strangers and hear "no" more often than "yes".
- You want a second income stream, not an escape from work.

This is not for you if

- You want a system that runs without you. Nothing here runs without you.
- You want to resell AI output unchanged. That is the fastest route to a short career and an angry client.
- You are looking for trading, crypto or investment income. Virtual-asset activity is prohibited where you live unless expressly authorised, and none of it is taught here.
- You cannot send a message to a business owner without feeling you are begging. You are offering a service at a price; that is not begging.
- You will not do the verification step because it is the slow part. The verification step is the product.

Nothing in this course requires you to leave salaried employment, and nothing here suggests that salaried work is a failure. A second income stream sits beside a job, a degree or a family business. It does not replace them.

OBJECTIVES AND METHOD

What you will be able to do, and how to work through this book

By the end, you should be able to

1. Describe twelve services you can deliver with a free AI chat tool, and say who buys each one and what it costs.
2. Run the six-stage workflow on a real piece of client work without skipping a stage.
3. Write a brief before you open any tool, and write a prompt with a role, task, audience, format, length, tone and constraints.
4. Verify a draft: check every number, every name, every promise and every local detail.
5. Rewrite AI text so it sounds like a person from a specific place wrote it.
6. Package three services into Starter, Standard and Monthly offers with example local prices.
7. Build a prospect list of 30 real businesses and send outreach that gets replies.
8. Deliver work, take a revision request without losing money, and get paid.

How to use this book on a phone

Read the section, then do the exercise in the same sitting. Keep one note open for prompts you copy, and one for client details. Copy a prompt into your note before you paste it into the tool, so a crash or a lost connection does not cost you the work.

Low-data mode

— Turn off image and video loading in your browser before you start a reading session.

— Do the reading in the evening if your connection is slow. Worst-case freelancer speeds reported where you live drop as low as 98 Kb/s, and the worst window is 16:00–24:00.

— Write prompts in your notes app offline, then paste them when you have signal.

— Never stream a video for a task that a paragraph could explain.

TWO DEVICES, ONE WORKFLOW

Phone path: research, prompts, drafts, captions, short documents, client messages, delivery. **Laptop path (borrowed counts):** long documents, slide outlines, spreadsheets of prospects, final PDF export. You can produce paid work with only the phone path — the laptop only makes the long jobs faster.

SHORT ON TIME

If you only have 5 hours

Some readers will not get eight hours this month. That is fine. This is the compressed path: read less, do more, and skip nothing that touches quality.

1. **40 minutes — choose one service**

   Read Section 01 and pick **one** service from the twelve. The fastest to sell with no portfolio are product descriptions and social captions. Write the service name and your starting price at the top of a note.

1. **50 minutes — learn the workflow**

   Read Section 02 end to end. Copy the brief template into your notes app. Do not read Section 03 yet.

1. **60 minutes — copy four prompts**

   From Section 03, copy only the prompts for your chosen service, plus the master prompt pattern and the "fix this" prompt. Four or five prompts is enough to begin.

1. **60 minutes — read Section 04 properly**

   Quality control is the part that keeps you paid. Do not skip it under time pressure. It is the shortest section and the most valuable one.

2. **60 minutes — build a list of ten**

   Open Google Maps. Search your service's client type in one neighbourhood. Write ten real businesses into a note with their phone number or Telegram handle. Send three messages using the script in Section 08.

3. **30 minutes — decide the rest**

   Skim Section 06 for prices, Section 09 for payment, and the final checklist in the back. Return to the full course when you have your first paying job.

> **WHAT THE 5-HOUR PATH LEAVES OUT**
>
> It leaves out the editing craft in Section 05, the full pricing ladder in Section 06, the 14-day plan, and the three worked case scenarios. Those are the parts that turn a first job into a second job. Come back for them.

THE HONEST AI REALITY

What free AI tools are good at, and what they are bad at

Most disappointment with AI comes from asking it to do the wrong half of the job. Free AI chat tools are strong at shape and weak at truth. Read the two columns below as a boundary, not as a review of any particular product.

Good at

— **First drafts.** Getting words on a page so you have something to improve.

— **Structure.** Turning a messy pile of notes into headings, sections and an order.

— **Rewriting.** Making a paragraph shorter, warmer, more formal, or clearer.

— **Summarising.** Reducing a long document you have already read.

— **A first-pass translation.** Producing a rough English or the local language version to work from.

— **Generating options.** Ten headline routes when you have none.

— **Consistency.** Applying one format to twenty product descriptions.

— **Checklists and question lists.** Building the questions you should ask a client.

Bad at

— **Facts.** Numbers, statistics, dates and names arrive unverified, and invented ones look identical to correct ones.

— **Local specifics.** Street names, sub-cities, landmarks, market rates and what a neighbourhood actually looks like.

— **Prices and fees.** Any figure it gives you is a guess dressed as information.

— **Legal, medical and financial claims.** Never deliver these from a draft.

— **Current events.** Anything after its training data, and it will not reliably tell you where that line falls.

— **the local language nuance.** Prose comes out stiff or wrong. Word-level help only, with a human reader.

— **Judgement.** Whether a claim is safe to publish, whether a client can honour a promise, whether a price is fair.

— **Your client's reality.** It has never met them, seen their shop or read their last five posts.

EXPLAIN A free AI chat tool predicts plausible text. Plausible is not the same as true, and it is not the same as useful. Your value is the difference between plausible and true.

SHOW Ask a tool for "three facts about local coffee exports". You will get three confident sentences. At least one will contain a number that nobody published. Ask it for the source, and it may produce a real-looking report title that does not exist.

DO Before you offer any research-style service, run that test yourself once. Seeing a confident wrong answer is the only reliable cure for trusting the next one.

CHECK You can state, in one sentence, which half of your service the tool does and which half you do. If you cannot, you are not ready to charge for it.

- [ ] I understand the tool produces drafts, not deliverables.
- [ ] I understand every number it gives me is unverified until I find it myself.
- [ ] I will check the current free limits of whichever tool I use before I build a workflow on it.

TWO RULES OF HONESTY

Free tiers change, and AI work is never something it is not

RULE ONE: FREE LIMITS MOVE

A free AI chat tool — availability and free limits may vary by country and account, so verify before you rely on it. Several providers offer free tiers, and those tiers change: message caps appear, models are swapped, features move behind a paid plan, and access differs by region. None of that is a reason to avoid the tools. It is a reason to **never build a client promise on a feature you have not tested this month**.

Before you accept a job, open the tool and run the exact task once. If it works today, you can quote for it today. If it fails, change the method, not the promise.

RULE TWO: NEVER MISREPRESENT THE WORK

Do not describe AI-assisted work as hand-written from scratch if the client is paying for original human writing. Do not claim research you did not do, sources you did not open, a team you do not have, a licence you do not hold, or a location you are not in.

Be accurate about what you did: "*I used AI tools to produce the first draft and a research assistant, then verified the facts, rewrote the copy in the client's voice and checked the local language with a native speaker.*" That sentence is honest, it is normal in 2026, and most clients accept it. A lie about your method is the one thing that ends a working relationship permanently.

01

SECTION ONE

What AI Can and Cannot Sell

The difference between owning a tool and selling a service, why clients pay for outcomes rather than technology, the five-minute test that filters out bad ideas, and the twelve services you can deliver with a free AI chat tool.

01 A tool is not a service

02 Why clients buy outcomes

03 The five-minute test

04 The twelve sellable services

05 Which one to start with

06 What you should refuse to sell

You cannot sell "AI". Nobody in the commercial district, a regional city or a regional city wakes up wanting to buy artificial intelligence. They wake up wanting a caption that does not sound like every other café, a product description that makes a buyer in Dubai trust them, or a CV that gets their cousin an interview.

This section separates the tool from the service. By the end you will have chosen one service, named a starting price, and understood exactly what could go wrong with it.

1.1 A tool is not a service

A tool is something you hold. A service is something you deliver. Thousands of people where you live now have access to the same free AI chat tools you do. Access is not scarce, so access cannot be sold. What is scarce is **a person who takes responsibility for the final result**.

Think about a sewing machine. The machine is cheap and common. A tailor is not, because a tailor measures the customer, chooses the cloth, cuts, fits, adjusts and stands behind the finished shirt. If you hand a customer a sewing machine and say "make your own shirt", you have not sold a service. That is exactly what happens when someone offers "AI content" to a business owner.

EXPLAIN The tool produces text. The service produces a finished, verified, client-specific result that the client can publish without risk.

SHOW A café owner asks for "some Instagram captions". The tool returns twelve lines about "the perfect blend of tradition and modernity". You deliver twelve captions that name the actual drink, the actual price, the actual neighbourhood and the actual reason a customer walks in at 7 a.m. — each one checked against the menu. Same tool. Different product.

DO Write one sentence describing what the client receives, with no mention of AI: "*Twelve ready-to-post captions for your Telegram and Instagram pages, with hashtags and a posting schedule, based on your real menu and prices.*"

CHECK You can read your sentence to a shop owner and they immediately understand what arrives, when, and what it is for.

1.2 Why clients buy outcomes, not tools

A business owner does not want a document. They want one of five things, and every service in this course maps to one of them:

01 More customers

Captions, product descriptions, flyer copy, website copy, SMS campaigns. The owner's problem is that people do not know they exist or do not trust them enough to visit.

02 Less wasted time

FAQ sheets, reply templates, document formatting, summarising long reports. The owner is answering the same twelve questions every day and formatting documents at midnight.

03 Fewer costly mistakes

Research briefs, comparison tables, proofreading, translation checks. The owner is about to spend money and does not want to guess.

04 A better impression

CVs, presentations, business profiles, professional emails, export documents. The owner or applicant is being judged by a stranger in the first thirty seconds.

Price follows the outcome, not the hours. Twelve captions that bring in one extra table a week are worth more to a café than the two hours you spent producing them.

That is why the same work can be priced at $5 for a kiosk and $19 for a hotel restaurant — and both prices can be fair.

1.3 The five-minute test

Before you commit to any service, run this test honestly. If a service fails more than one line, put it down and choose another.

THE FIVE-MINUTE TEST

1. **Can I deliver this in under an hour** using a free tool and my own checking, for a normal-sized version of the job?
2. **Can I verify the output** — every number, name, date and promise — with information the client gives me or that I can check at a real source?
3. **Can I add something the tool cannot?** Local knowledge, a real photo description, an understanding of the client's actual customers, judgement about what is safe to publish.
4. **Would I be comfortable if the client published it today** with my name attached?
5. **Can I explain what I did** in two sentences if the client asks how it was made?

A service that fails question 2 is a service that will eventually embarrass you. A service that fails question 3 is not a service, it is reselling.

1.4 The twelve sellable services

These are real, ordinary services that small local businesses, sellers and organisers already pay people to do. Every price below is an **example** for a beginner with no portfolio, in a mid-sized local city, in September 2026. Adjust to your market and experience. Nothing here is a promise of what you will earn.

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
1. Social-media captions and posting copy — short post text for Facebook, Instagram and Telegram	Cafés, restaurants, gyms, salons, boutiques, guest houses with active pages	12 captions, hashtag sets, and a simple posting calendar for the month	1,500–$19	2–3 days	Generic, over-polished lines that could describe any business; wrong prices or opening hours stated as fact
2. Product descriptions for online sellers — titles, descriptions and bullet points for items for sale	Telegram shop owners, a local classifieds site sellers, Instagram boutiques, small exporters	10–20 product descriptions with a title, short description, bullet points and keywords	800–$16	1–2 days	Invented materials, sizes, weights or features the seller does not actually offer

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
3. Simple marketing copy for flyers, posters and SMS — headline, body and call to action	Shops, clinics, training centres, event organisers, community and church groups	Flyer copy, three poster headline options, and a 160-character SMS version	600–$12	1 day	Numbers, dates, addresses and phone numbers the tool guessed. One wrong digit wastes the whole print run

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
4. Research briefs and summaries — a short structured note on a question the client is deciding on	NGOs, consultants, students, importers, business owners entering a new category	A 2–4 page brief with headings, a comparison table, open questions and a source list	1,500–$120	3–5 days	Fabricated statistics and fabricated citations. The highest-risk service in this list
5. Document formatting and cleanup — making a messy document presentable	Anyone with a long Word or Google Docs file: reports, proposals, manuals, theses	Consistent headings, spacing, page numbers, a table of contents and a clean PDF	500–$12	1–2 days	Low risk. The real danger is deleting content by accident — always keep the original untouched
6. CV and cover-letter improvement — rewriting an existing CV and tailoring a letter	Job seekers, graduates, scholarship and visa applicants	A rewritten CV, one tailored cover letter, and a short note explaining what changed	700–$16	1–2 days	Inflated claims the applicant cannot defend in an interview. Never add experience they do not have

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
7. Presentation assistance — outline, wording and speaker notes for a talk	Students, trainers, sales staff, managers preparing an internal review	A slide-by-slide outline with speaker notes and tighter wording for each slide	800–$19	2–3 days	Slides that look complete but contain no specific facts; no visuals, which the client must supply
8. Translation assistance and proofreading — cleaning and checking text in English or the local language	Businesses writing to foreign buyers, NGOs, anyone publishing in a second language	A corrected text, a list of every change made, and a list of sentences you could not resolve	10–$25 per 100 words	1–3 days	Meaning drift, especially the local language. Never deliver the local language without a fluent human reading the final version
9. Content repurposing — turning one recording or long post into many pieces	Creators, event organisers, training centres, podcasters, guest speakers	10–15 short posts, one article, one email and a set of captions drawn from one source	1,200–$22	2–4 days	Misquoting the speaker and inventing details that were never said. Every quote must be checked against the recording

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
10. Business idea validation notes — structured questions and a market note before someone spends money	Someone about to open a shop, add a product line or buy stock	A one-page note: who else does this, what they appear to charge, where demand sits, what to check next	1,000–$19	2–4 days	Confident answers built on nothing. This service sells structure and questions, never certainty

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
11. Customer-support scripts and FAQ sheets — the answers a business repeats every day	Shops with a busy Telegram or phone line, clinics, hotels, delivery services	15–25 FAQ answers, escalation rules, and three ready reply templates	1,000–$19	2–3 days	Promises the business cannot keep: refund policies, delivery times, guarantees, opening hours

SERVICE AND WHAT IT IS	WHO BUYS IT	WHAT THE CLIENT RECEIVES	EXAMPLE PRICE	DELIVERY	HONEST QUALITY RISK
12. Simple website copy and email writing — the words on a small site, and business emails	Businesses with a Facebook page but no proper site; anyone writing to a buyer or an institution	Home, About, Services and Contact copy, plus two email templates	1,500–$28	3–5 days	Wrong service lists and locations, and invented claims such as years of experience the business does not have

Example prices only, for a beginner with no portfolio in September 2026. They are illustrative, not standard rates. Adjust to your market, your city and your experience. Many local small businesses are not durable advertisers — more than 80% of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025 — so expect to work with businesses that are actively trading and actively posting.

1.5 Which one to start with

Fastest to first sale

Product descriptions and **captions**. Every online seller needs them, they are quick to demonstrate, and a sample costs you under an hour. Start here if you have no portfolio at all.

Best paid per hour

Research briefs and **website copy**. Higher prices, but the fact-checking load is heavy and one invented statistic can cost you the client. Start here only after you are confident in Section 04.

Lowest risk

Document formatting and **presentation assistance**. Almost nothing can be factually wrong, so it is a safe way to build confidence and collect a first payment.

PICK ONE, NOT FOUR

Choose one service for the next fourteen days. A reader who offers "AI content, translation, research and design" reads as someone who does none of them well. A reader who says "I write product descriptions for online sellers, ten for $8, delivered in two days" reads as a supplier.

1.6 What you should refuse to sell

NEVER SELL THESE

— **Legal, medical or financial advice** of any kind, even "just a summary". Point the client to a professional.

— **Guaranteed results.** No promise of sales, followers, visa approval, funding or ranking.

— **Fake reviews, fake testimonials or fake follower counts.** This damages the client and it damages you.

— **Academic work submitted as a student's own.** Proofreading and formatting are fine. Writing the assignment is not.

— **Anything that requires credentials you do not hold** — certified translation, auditing, tax filing, engineering documents.

— **Content that misrepresents a business** — fake locations, fake years in operation, fake certifications.

Turning down this work costs you one job. Accepting it can cost you your reputation in a market where everyone in a sector knows everyone else.

SECTION 01 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Write these four lines in your notes app and keep them there: **(1)** the one service you are starting with, **(2)** who buys it, **(3)** your starting price in USD, **(4)** your delivery time. Then read Section 02 and learn the workflow that turns that promise into something you can actually hand over.

02

SECTION TWO

The Production Workflow

Brief, prompt, draft, verify, edit, deliver — the six stages that turn a vague idea into a deliverable. What each stage produces, what goes wrong when you skip one, and the one-page brief you fill in before you open any tool.

01 The six stages at a glance

02 The workflow as a one-page diagram

03 What breaks when you skip a stage

04 The client brief template

05 Two speeds: the 45-minute job and the three-hour job

Amateurs open the AI tool first and think afterwards. Professionals write the brief first, and the tool never sees the job until the brief exists.

The workflow in this section is the spine of the whole course. Every other section hangs off it. Learn it once and you can apply it to a caption set, a research brief or a five-page website.

2.1 The six stages

1. **Brief — decide what "finished" means**

   Before any tool opens, you write down who the client is, who their customer is, what they are selling, what the deliverable is, how long it should be, what must be included, what must never be said, and when it is due. The brief is a page of text, not a feeling.

2. **Prompt — give the tool a full instruction**

   You convert the brief into one structured instruction: role, task, audience, format, length, tone, constraints and examples. A weak prompt produces a weak draft, and no amount of editing rescues a draft built on the wrong assignment.

3. **Draft — get material on the page**

   The tool produces a first version. Treat it as raw material, the way a carpenter treats unplaned timber. Read it once without editing, then set it aside for ten minutes if you can.

4. **Verify — check every claim**

   Numbers, names, dates, prices, addresses, policies, laws, health claims, quotes and sources. Anything you cannot confirm with the client, a photograph, a menu, a signboard or a real published source gets removed or turned into a question.

5. **Edit — make it sound like a person from here**

   Cut the generic openings, break the balanced sentences, add local truth: the real neighbourhood, the real dish, the real season, the real customer moment. This is the stage clients are really paying for.

6. **Deliver — hand over cleanly**

   Correct file name, correct format, one short message explaining what is inside, what you checked, what you could not confirm and how revisions work.

2.2 The workflow as a one-page diagram

Print this page or copy it into your notes. It is the whole method on one screen.

1 BRIEF

Input: answers from the client.
Output: one page: audience, deliverable, length, must-haves, never-says, deadline.
Owner: you, offline.

2 PROMPT

Input: the brief.
Output: one structured instruction.
Owner: you, with the tool closed until the instruction is written.

3 DRAFT

Input: the prompt.
Output: raw text, clearly labelled DRAFT.
Owner: the tool — and it is never shown to anyone in this state.

4 VERIFY

Input: the draft plus the client's facts.
Output: every claim marked true, false or unknown.
Owner: you, with a checklist.

5 EDIT

Input: the verified draft.
Output: text that reads as if written for this client only.
Owner: you, slowly, out loud.

6 DELIVER

Input: the final text and files.
Output: a clean handover message and named files.
Owner: you, on time.

THE RULE THAT KEEPS THIS HONEST

Stages 1, 4, 5 and 6 are yours. Stage 3 is the tool's. Stage 2 is shared — you write the instruction, the tool executes it. **Four of the six stages have nothing to do with AI**, and those four are where your price comes from.

2.3 What breaks when you skip a stage

STAGE SKIPPED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU
Brief	You produce beautiful captions for a business that wanted a price list	A full redo, unpaid, plus a client who now doubts you
Prompt	The draft is a general essay about the industry instead of copy for one shop	An hour of editing that produces something no better than the client could write
Draft discipline	You send the first output because it reads well	An invented fact reaches the client's customers
Verify	A wrong opening time, a wrong price, a statistic with a fake source	The client's reputation, and yours. This is the mistake that ends relationships
Edit	The text is correct but sounds like every other page on the internet	No second job. The client cannot explain why your work is better
Deliver	A file called `document(3).docx` and no explanation	Confusion, extra messages, and a client who feels the job is unfinished

2.4 The client brief template

Send this as a short list of questions, or fill it in yourself from a ten-minute conversation, a look at the client's page and a photograph of the menu or price list. Never open an AI tool before this page exists.

COPY-READY: THE BRIEF I FILL IN BEFORE I TOUCH ANY TOOL

Client: [business name] **Type:** [café / clothing shop / tutoring centre]

Where: [neighbourhood, city]

Who their customer is: [office workers at lunch / students after 4 p.m. / mothers on Saturday]

What they sell: [three to five specific items or services, with real prices]

What I am delivering: [exact deliverable and quantity]

Length or size: [characters per caption / words per description / pages]

Language: [English / the local language / both] **Tone:** [warm and plain / formal]

Must include: [name, phone, opening hours, location, price, offer]

Must never say: [delivery promise they cannot keep, competitor names, health claims, "best where you live"]

Facts I have confirmed with the client: [list them]

Facts I still need: [list them — do not guess these]

Deadline: [date and time] **Revisions included:** [one round]

My service (one only) .....

The three facts I must confirm every time .....

The one thing this client must never see in my draft .....

My delivery deadline buffer .....

2.5 Two speeds

The 45-minute job — small, repeatable

Brief (8 min): read the client's last ten posts, note three real details.
Prompt (5 min): paste your saved master prompt, fill the brackets.
Draft (2 min): one output, maybe two.
Verify (10 min): check prices, hours, address, offers against the client's own material.
Edit (15 min): rewrite every opening line and add one local detail per item.
Deliver (5 min): correct file name, one message.

Good for: five product descriptions, five captions, one SMS campaign, one FAQ page.

The three-hour job — bigger, higher priced

Brief (25 min): a call or a voice-note exchange with the client, notes written up.
Prompt (15 min): master prompt plus a structure prompt, run in stages.
Draft (15 min): section by section, not all at once.
Verify (60 min): every number traced to a real source or removed.
Edit (50 min): read the whole thing aloud; rewrite anything that sounds generic.
Deliver (15 min): clean files, a short note on what you checked and what is open.

Good for: research briefs, website copy, a month of captions, presentation outlines.

THE MISTAKE BEGINNERS MAKE WITH TIME

Beginners quote for the drafting time and forget the verification time, which is usually longer. If a job takes you three hours, two of those hours are checking and rewriting. Price the whole three hours, and tell the client a realistic delivery date — not the date you would hit if nothing went wrong.

SECTION 02 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Copy the brief template into your notes app and fill it in for one real business you can see from where you live or study. You now have a live prospect and a written brief. Section 03 turns that brief into a prompt.

03

SECTION THREE

Prompt Engineering for People Who Are Not Engineers

The eight parts of a prompt that works, three local tasks shown as a vague prompt beside a working prompt, a master prompt you can reuse forever, a "fix this" prompt for rescuing weak output, and more than forty copy-ready prompts organised by service.

01 The anatomy of a working prompt

02 Vague prompt versus working prompt: three real tasks

03 The master prompt pattern

04 The "fix this" prompt

05 Forty-plus copy-ready prompts by service

A prompt is not a magic phrase. It is an instruction. If you gave the same instruction to a new assistant on their first day, would they know what to produce? If not, the prompt is the problem.

Everything in this section is copy-ready. Replace the bracketed parts, paste, and work from what comes back.

3.1 The anatomy of a working prompt

Eight parts. You will not need all eight every time, but when output disappoints, one of them is missing.

PART	WHAT IT DOES	EXAMPLE WORDING
1. Role	Tells the tool which kind of writing to imitate	"You are a copywriter for small local food businesses."
2. Task	States the one thing you want produced	"Write twelve Instagram captions."
3. Audience	Who will read it, and what they care about	"Office workers in the commercial district looking for a fast lunch under $2."
4. Format	The shape of the output	"A numbered list. Each caption followed by five hashtags."
5. Length	Stops the tool writing an essay	"Maximum 180 characters per caption."
6. Tone	How it should sound	"Plain, warm, spoken. No hype words."
7. Constraints	The rules it must not break	"Use only these prices. Do not invent offers. Do not mention competitors."
8. Examples	Shows the shape of a good answer	"Here are two captions the client liked last month: …"

THE SINGLE BIGGEST IMPROVEMENT

Paste the client's real material into the prompt: the menu, the price list, three of their own posts, the exact product details. Most weak output is not the tool's fault — the tool was asked to write about a business it has never seen. **Give it the facts and it stops inventing them.**

3.2 Vague prompt versus working prompt

Three real tasks. The left column is what most people type. The right column is the same job done properly.

Task 1 — café captions: weak

```
Write Instagram captions for a café in your city.
```

Result: twelve lines about "the perfect blend of tradition and modernity", nothing about the actual place, nothing usable.

Task 1 — café captions: working

```
You are a copywriter for small food businesses in your city. Write 12 Instagram captions for Riverside Coffee House, a 20-seat café near the commercial district Medhanialem. Customers: office workers at lunch and students after 4 p.m. Menu facts: macchiato $0.40, firfir $180, shiro $1, breakfast served 7–11 a.m., closed Sunday. Format: numbered list; each caption under 180 characters, then 5 hashtags. Tone: plain and warm, like a regular customer talking. Do not invent dishes, prices or offers. Do not use the words "delicious", "perfect" or "vibe". Example caption the owner liked: "The 7 a.m. macchiato crowd is back. We open at seven."
```

Task 2 — product description: weak

```
Write a product description for a leather bag.
```

Result: an invented bag with invented measurements and a "timeless elegance" line that no buyer believes.

Task 2 — product description: working

```
You write product listings for an local leather goods seller on Telegram and a local classifieds site. Write one description for this item: hand-stitched leather messenger bag; full-grain cowhide from a tannery in Modjo; 38 cm wide, 28 cm tall, 10 cm deep; one main compartment, one inner pocket, adjustable strap; colours dark brown and black; price $28; made in your city. Buyer: a professional aged 25–40 who wants something durable, not luxury branding. Format: title under 60 characters, then a 60-word description, then 5 bullet points, then 8 search keywords. Rules: use only the facts above. Do not invent materials, sizes, warranties or delivery times. Do not claim it is handmade in Italy or compare it to a named brand.
```

Task 3 — business profile: weak

```
Write a Google Business Profile description for a hotel.
```

Result: a paragraph that could describe any hotel anywhere, with an invented star rating.

Task 3 — business profile: working

```
Write a Google Business Profile "About"
description of 700–750 characters for a
hotel. Facts: 24 rooms; located 600 m
from the lake shore in a regional city;
on-site restaurant serving local and
continental breakfast from 6:30 a.m.;
free parking for 8 cars; airport pickup
on request; rooms from $2,200 per night;
Wi-Fi in the lobby. Guest: local business
travellers and families visiting for
weekends. Tone: factual and welcoming, no
superlatives. Rules: state only the facts
listed. Do not invent room types, star
ratings, awards, pool, gym or spa. Do not
claim "best in a regional city". End with
the phone number as [phone].
```

3.3 The master prompt pattern

Save this once and reuse it for every job. Fill the brackets and delete what does not apply.

COPY-READY: THE MASTER PROMPT PATTERN

You are a `[role: copywriter / research assistant / editor]` working for a `[type of business]` in `[city or neighbourhood]`.

Task: produce `[exact deliverable and quantity]`.

Audience: `[who reads it and what they care about]`.

Facts you must use: `[paste the real menu, price list, product details, opening hours, address]`.

Format: `[numbered list / table / sections]`. **Length:** `[characters or words]`.

Tone: `[plain and warm / formal and factual]`.

Rules: Use only the facts above. Do not invent prices, statistics, offers, dates or sources. Do not mention competitors by name. Do not use the words `[banned words]`. Mark anything you are unsure about as NEEDS CHECK.

Example of the shape I want: `[paste one real example the client liked]`

COPY-READY: THE "FIX THIS" PROMPT

Below is a draft I am not happy with. Act as a strict editor, not as a writer. Do not rewrite it yet.

1. List every sentence that is vague, generic or could apply to any business.

2. List every factual claim in the draft and mark it as VERIFIED BY ME, NOT VERIFIED, or INVENTED.

3. List any promise, policy or claim a small business might not be able to honour.

4. List anything that sounds like it was written by a machine rather than a person.

5. Then, and only then, suggest specific replacements for the worst five lines, keeping the same meaning.

Draft: `[paste the draft]`

Client facts: `[paste the confirmed facts]`

USE THE CRITIC PASS CORRECTLY

A second AI pass is useful for spotting weak sentences and for showing you where a claim is unsupported. It is **not** a source. If the critic says "this statistic is correct", that means nothing. Only your own check against a real source counts. See Section 04.

3.4 Forty-plus copy-ready prompts, by service

Replace every bracketed part. Keep the rules lines — they are what stop the tool inventing details.

Social-media captions and posting copy

PROMPT 01 — CAPTION SET FROM REAL FACTS

You write social captions for small small local businesses. Write `[12]` captions for `[business name]`, a `[type]` in `[neighbourhood, city]`. Facts: `[paste menu or services with real prices, opening hours, address]`. Audience: `[who]`. Each caption under `[180]` characters, then 5 hashtags. Plain warm tone. Use only the facts given. No invented offers or prices. No banned hype words.

PROMPT 02 — A 30-DAY POSTING CALENDAR

Build a 30-day content calendar for `[business]`. Facts: `[products, prices, opening hours, busy days]`. Output a table: day, post type (product, behind the scenes, customer question, staff, offer, reminder), the specific angle, and one line of example text. Vary the types so no two consecutive days repeat. Do not invent events, holidays or discounts.

PROMPT 03 — FIVE ANGLES FOR ONE PHOTOGRAPH

Here is a description of one photo the client will post: `[describe exactly what is in the photo]`. Write five different captions for it: one practical, one warm, one asking a question, one behind-the-scenes, one short and plain. Under `[150]` characters each. Facts available: `[list]`. Do not add anything not in the facts.

PROMPT 04 — HASHTAG SETS

Create three hashtag sets of [8] tags each for [business type] in [city]: one broad, one neighbourhood-specific, one product-specific. Format: three labelled lines. Use ordinary descriptive tags a real customer would search. Do not use tags about giveaways, followers or engagement.

PROMPT 05 — A SEASON OR HOLIDAY CAPTION

Write [3] captions for [business] during [season or holiday, e.g. the local fasting period, a national holiday, Ramadan, exam week]. Facts: [what actually changes for the business in that period: menu, hours, demand]. Keep each under [170] characters. Do not name religious authorities, do not claim religious endorsement, and do not invent special offers.

Product descriptions for online sellers

PROMPT 06 — ONE PRODUCT, FULL LISTING

You write listings for local online sellers. Product: [name]. Facts: [material, size, weight, colour, price in dollars, what is included, where it is made]. Buyer: [who]. Output: a title under 60 characters, a 60-word description, 5 bullet points, and 8 search keywords. Use only the facts given. Do not invent materials, dimensions, warranties or delivery times.

PROMPT 07 — TEN ITEMS IN ONE CONSISTENT FORMAT

Below are [10] products with their details. Write one description for each in exactly the same format: title, one-sentence summary, three bullets, price line. Keep the tone identical across all ten. Do not invent any detail that is not listed. Products: [paste the list]

PROMPT 08 — KEYWORD PASS FOR SEARCH

For this product listing: [paste the listing], suggest [10] search terms a buyer where you live might actually type, and show where each one fits naturally in the existing text. Do not stuff keywords. Do not change the facts. Output as a two-column table: keyword, where it goes.

PROMPT 09 — EXPORT-BUYER VERSION

Rewrite this product description for a foreign wholesale buyer: [paste]. Buyer cares about consistency, packaging, capacity and documentation, not lifestyle language. Output: a 100-word factual description, then a table with the fields [product, grade, packaging, minimum order, lead time]. Where a field is unknown, write NEEDS CONFIRMATION. Do not invent certifications, grades or capacity figures.

Marketing copy for flyers, posters and SMS

PROMPT 10 — FLYER COPY

Write copy for a printed flyer for [business] in [city]. Facts: [what is offered, price, dates, location, phone]. Output: a headline of 6 words or fewer, three alternative headlines, one 40-word body paragraph, and a call to action. Plain language. No exclamation marks. Do not invent discounts, dates or phone numbers.

PROMPT 11 — SMS VERSION, 160 CHARACTERS

Turn this message into an SMS of under 160 characters including the phone number: [message]. Keep the most important detail first. Write three versions. Do not shorten the phone number or the date. Do not add an offer that is not in the original.

PROMPT 12 — POSTER HEADLINES

Give me 10 headline options for a poster for [offer] aimed at [audience] in [place]. Each headline under 7 words. Five should be practical and five should be warm. Do not use the words [banned words]. Then tell me which two you would test first and why, in one sentence each.

PROMPT 13 — SPOKEN ANNOUNCEMENT SCRIPT

Write a 30-second spoken announcement for [business or event] to be read aloud in [language]. Facts: [list]. Short sentences that are easy to read at speed. Include the name, the offer, the location, the date and the phone number. Do not add claims about quality or popularity.

Research briefs and summaries

PROMPT 14 — STRUCTURE A BRIEF

I am writing a short research brief on this question: [question]. Do not answer it. Instead, give me the structure: six section headings, the three sub-questions each section should answer, and the two facts I must verify from a primary source before writing anything. Output as a list.

PROMPT 15 — SUMMARISE A DOCUMENT THE CLIENT GAVE ME

Below is a document the client provided. Summarise it in [250] words, then list every number that appears in it with the sentence it came from. Do not add any fact that is not in the document. Do not add outside context. If something is ambiguous, list it under OPEN QUESTIONS. Document: [paste]

PROMPT 16 — COMPARISON TABLE

Build a comparison table for [options being compared] with these columns: [option, what it includes, price, time required, main risk, who it suits]. Use only the information I give you below. Where I have not given a figure, write NOT PROVIDED rather than estimating. Information: [paste]

PROMPT 17 — THE QUESTIONS TO ASK

My client is deciding whether to [decision]. Write 15 questions they should be able to answer before spending money. Group them as: customers, costs, competition, operations, risk. For each question, add one line explaining why the answer changes the decision. Do not include any statistics or figures.

Document formatting and cleanup

PROMPT 18 — CHECK THE STRUCTURE OF A DOCUMENT

Below is the text of a document with messy structure. Do not rewrite the wording. Instead list: the heading levels that should exist, which lines are headings, which paragraphs belong under each heading, and any place where the order seems wrong. Text: [paste]

PROMPT 19 — CONSISTENT HEADINGS AND NUMBERING

Rewrite only the headings and numbering of this document so they follow one consistent style: [1.1, 1.2, 1.3]. Do not change any body text. Return the full document with the corrected headings, and then a short list of the changes you made. Document: [paste]

PROMPT 20 — PLAIN-LANGUAGE REWRITE OF A NOTICE

Rewrite this notice in plain language at roughly a [Grade 8] reading level, keeping every fact and every requirement exactly as it is. Do not remove any condition. Do not add any new rule. Then list any sentence whose meaning you were unsure about. Notice: [paste]

CV and cover-letter improvement

PROMPT 21 — CV REWRITE, NO INVENTED EXPERIENCE

Rewrite this CV. Rules you must not break: do not add any job, qualification, date, skill or number that is not already present; do not upgrade a job title; do not invent metrics. Improve only the order, the wording and the clarity. Then list every change you made. CV: [paste]

PROMPT 22 — TAILORED COVER LETTER

Write a cover letter of under 300 words for this role: [paste the job advert]. Candidate facts: [education, experience, two concrete achievements]. Structure: why this role, what the candidate brings with one example, what they want to learn, a closing line. Use only the facts given. Do not claim passion, do not use the phrase "I am writing to apply", do not invent experience.

PROMPT 23 — TURN PLAIN FACTS INTO ACHIEVEMENT BULLETS

Here are plain facts about a job: [list what the person actually did]. Turn each into one CV bullet of under 20 words, starting with a verb. Do not add numbers that are not in my list. If a bullet would be stronger with a number, write it as [add number] instead of guessing one.

PROMPT 24 — INTERVIEW PREPARATION FROM THE CV

Based on this CV: [paste], list the 12 questions an interviewer is most likely to ask, and for each one note which line of the CV prompted it. Then flag any claim in the CV that the candidate may struggle to defend, so they can prepare an honest answer.

Presentation assistance

PROMPT 25 — SLIDE-BY-SLIDE OUTLINE

Build a [12]-slide outline for a [20]-minute talk on [topic] for [audience]. Output a table: slide number, slide title under 8 words, three bullets of no more than 10 words each, and one line saying what the speaker should say that is not on the slide. Do not include statistics.

PROMPT 26 — SPEAKER NOTES

Write speaker notes of about [90] words per slide for this outline: [paste outline]. Spoken language, short sentences. Each set of notes must include one concrete example the speaker can tell from their own experience, marked as [YOUR EXAMPLE HERE]. Do not invent facts or figures.

PROMPT 27 — CUT A LONG DECK DOWN

This deck has [40] slides and must become [15]. Slides: [paste titles and bullets]. Tell me which slides to merge, which to cut, and which single slide carries the main argument. Keep every fact that appears in the original somewhere in the new deck, or list it as DROPPED so I can decide.

Translation assistance and proofreading

PROMPT 28 — PROOFREAD AND LIST THE CHANGES

Proofread this English text for grammar, clarity and consistency. Do not change the meaning and do not make it more formal than it is. Output: the corrected text, then a table with three columns — original phrase, corrected phrase, reason. Text: [paste]

PROMPT 29 — TRANSLATE WITH A FIXED TERMINOLOGY LIST

Translate this text into [target language]. Use exactly these terms and no others: [term = translation, term = translation]. Keep proper nouns unchanged. Keep the sentence order as close to the original as the language allows. After the translation, list every sentence you were not confident about. Text: [paste]

PROMPT 30 — BACK-TRANSLATION CHECK

Translate this [the local language] text into English literally, without smoothing it: [paste]. Then point out any phrase that has more than one possible meaning in English, and any place where the original seems to be missing a word or a verb. Do not improve the text.

Content repurposing

PROMPT 31 — ONE RECORDING INTO TEN POSTS

Below is a transcript of a [30]-minute talk. Produce 10 short posts of under 60 words each. For each post give the source line from the transcript verbatim so I can check it. Do not add any fact, name or number that is not in the transcript. Transcript: [paste]

PROMPT 32 — LONG POST INTO ONE SHORT ARTICLE

Turn this long post into a [400]-word article with three subheadings. Keep every fact from the original article. Do not add examples or context from outside it. List anything you had to leave out. Post: [paste]

PROMPT 33 — PULL THE QUOTABLE LINES

From this transcript, extract every sentence that would work as a standalone quote. For each, give the exact wording and the approximate position in the recording. Then mark which ones need the speaker's approval because they could be misread out of context. Transcript: [paste]

Business idea validation notes

PROMPT 34 — THE COMPETITOR QUESTION LIST

My client wants to open [business] in [neighbourhood, city]. Do not give me market data. Give me a list of 12 things they must physically go and look at in that neighbourhood this week — who is already there, what they charge, what hours they keep, what is missing. Format: a checklist with space for notes.

PROMPT 35 — UNIT ECONOMICS WORKSHEET

Build a blank worksheet my client can fill in for [product or service]. Rows: selling price, material cost per unit, packaging, transport, staff time per unit, monthly rent share, monthly utilities share, monthly data or phone, other. Then a row for units needed per month to cover all costs. Leave every value empty for the client to complete. Do not estimate any figure yourself.

PROMPT 36 — THE RISK LIST

List 12 risks for a small [type of business] in [city], grouped as money, supply, staffing, rules and demand. For each risk: one line on how it would show up early, and one line on what the owner could do about it. Do not include any statistic or legal claim. Mark anything that requires a professional opinion as [ASK A PROFESSIONAL].

Customer-support scripts and FAQ sheets

PROMPT 37 — FAQ FROM REAL ENQUIRIES

Here are [20] real questions customers sent this business: [paste]. Group them into [8] topics. For each topic write one clear answer of under 60 words using only these confirmed facts: [delivery, payment, hours, returns, location]. Where a fact is missing, write NEEDS OWNER ANSWER instead of guessing.

PROMPT 38 — THREE REPLY TEMPLATES

Write three customer-service reply templates for [business]: one for a price question, one for a delay complaint, one for a request the business cannot meet. Each under 70 words, polite, plain, no apology that admits fault the business did not cause. Facts available: [list]. Do not promise refunds, dates or compensation.

PROMPT 39 — ESCALATION RULES

Write an escalation rule sheet for a small business handling messages on Telegram and phone. Rules for: when to answer immediately, when to ask the owner, when to stop replying, and what must never be promised in writing. Output as a table: situation, who handles it, what to say, what never to say. Keep it to eight rows.

Website copy and email writing

PROMPT 40 — HOMEPAGE COPY

Write website copy for [business] in [city]. Facts: [what they do, who for, what is included, prices, location, phone, years in operation]. Output: a headline under 10 words, a subheadline of one sentence, three service blocks of 40 words each, and a contact line. Use only the facts given. Do not invent years of experience, certifications, client names or guarantees.

PROMPT 41 — ABOUT PAGE THAT IS NOT EMPTY

Write a 200-word About page for [business]. Facts: [who started it, when, why, what they make or do, where they are]. Plain, first person plural, no inspirational language. Do not invent a founding story, a mission statement or values. If a fact is missing, leave [ADD HERE].

PROMPT 42 — FIRST EMAIL TO A FOREIGN BUYER

Write a short cold email, under 150 words, introducing [business] to a potential buyer abroad. Facts: [product, capacity, packaging, location, what is already exported if anything]. Structure: who we are in one line, what we can supply with specifics, one question that is easy to answer. Formal but not stiff. No attachments mentioned unless I say so. Do not invent certifications, volumes or client names.

PROMPT 43 — FOLLOW-UP EMAIL THAT IS NOT ANNOYING

Write a follow-up email, under 90 words, to someone who did not reply to my first message about **[subject]**. Add one piece of new information rather than repeating the first email. Offer an easy exit: one line saying they can tell me to stop. No guilt, no urgency, no "just checking in".

HOW TO KEEP YOUR PROMPTS

Keep your twenty best prompts in one note, grouped by service. After every job, add one line to the prompt that would have prevented the problem you had to fix by hand. A prompt library that improves with each client is an asset you own — and it is the raw material for a sellable product later, which Course 06 covers.

SECTION 03 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Copy the master prompt, the "fix this" prompt, and the four prompts for your chosen service into a note called `prompts`. Run the master prompt once on a real business you already know, using only facts you are certain about. Keep the output. Section 04 is about what you do with it before anyone else sees it.

04

SECTION FOUR

Quality Control: The Part That Gets You Rehired

Fact verification, using a second AI pass as a critic rather than a source, three local examples of plausible-but-wrong output, plagiarism and confidentiality, a client-facing confidentiality promise, and the checklist you run before you press send.

01 Every number is unverified until you check it

02 Using a second AI pass as a critic

03 Hallucination: three local examples

04 Plagiarism and original work

05 Confidentiality

06 Before you press send

Clients rarely leave because a caption was dull. They leave because a wrong opening time was published, a fake statistic appeared in a report with their logo on it, or their customer list ended up somewhere it should not be.

This is the shortest section in the course and the one that decides whether you get a second job. Read it twice.

4.1 Every number is unverified until you find it yourself

Adopt one rule and never bend it: **any figure the AI gives you is unverified until you have seen it at a source you trust, with your own eyes.** Not a source the AI named. A source you opened.

"Source you trust" means one of these, in this order:

1. **The client's own material** — their menu, price list, signboard, invoice, licence, product in your hand.
2. **A photograph or a voice note from the client** confirming the detail.
3. **An official published source you opened yourself** — a government notice, a regulator's page, a company's own website.
4. **A named person at the client's business** who confirms it in writing.

If a fact fits none of those four, it does not go in the deliverable. You either delete the sentence or turn it into a question for the client. Both are acceptable. Guessing is not.

THE FOUR THINGS YOU MUST ALWAYS VERIFY

— **Numbers:** prices, quantities, dates, times, percentages, distances, capacities.

— **Names:** the business, its staff, its products, its partners, its location.

— **Promises:** delivery times, refunds, guarantees, opening hours, availability.

— **Claims about other people:** competitors, suppliers, certifications, awards, partnerships.

4.2 Using a second AI pass as a critic, not as a source

A second pass through the tool is genuinely useful — for finding weak sentences, contradictions and unsupported claims. It becomes dangerous the moment you treat its agreement as confirmation.

Safe uses of a second pass

— "List every factual claim in this draft."

— "Which sentences could apply to any business?"

— "Where does this contradict the facts I gave you?"

— "Which line is the weakest, and why?"

— "Rewrite these three lines only."

Unsafe uses

— "Is this statistic correct?"

— "Find me a source for this."

— "Confirm this is the current price."

— "Is this legal where you live?"

— "Did this really happen?"

The first column produces a shorter list for you to check. The second column produces confident nonsense that sounds like verification. It is not verification. Only the four sources in 4.1 count.

4.3 Hallucination: what it looks like where you live

A hallucination is output that is fluent, specific and wrong. It rarely looks like an error. It looks like the best paragraph in the draft. Here are three examples of the kind of thing that appears when you prompt carelessly. **These are illustrative examples written for teaching, not quotations from any tool.**

01 The invented statistic

"According to a 2025 report, local coffee exports rose 12.4% year on year, with Germany the largest buyer."

Why it is believable: it has a year, a percentage and a country. **Why it is dangerous:** the number is invented, and the report it implies may not exist. **Fix:** delete, or replace with a figure you have opened at an official source yourself. Never keep a statistic because it sounds right.

02 The wrong local detail

"Open every day from 7 a.m., including Sunday. We are a two-minute walk from the market."

Why it is believable: opening hours and walking distances are exactly what a caption needs. **Why it is dangerous:** the tool has never been to the neighbourhood and does not know the client closes on Sunday. **Fix:** every hour, day and distance comes from the client in writing.

03 The invented rule or fee

"Payments above $12 need a business licence, and the platform charges 3% on transfers."

Why it is believable: rules and fees do exist and the sentence has the shape of one. **Why it is dangerous:** you may repeat it to a client as fact. **Fix:** payment rules and fees come from the provider or the regulator, checked by you, never from a draft.

How to catch them

- [ ] Re-read the draft and mark **every** number, name, date and promise with a pen or a highlight.
- [ ] For each mark, write where it came from. If you cannot name the source, it is not verified.
- [ ] Ask the tool: "List every factual claim in your previous answer and mark each one as something I gave you or something you added."
- [ ] Ask the tool: "What would you need to check to be sure of the numbers above?" — then check those things yourself.
- [ ] Look for unnecessary specificity: oddly precise percentages, exact distances, plausible report titles.
- [ ] Read the draft out loud. A sentence that is suspiciously tidy is worth a second look.

4.4 Plagiarism: the line you do not cross

Two separate problems share the name. Both can end a client relationship.

Copying another person's text

AI tools sometimes reproduce passages close to their training material. If the client asked for original writing and you hand over a passage that already exists elsewhere, you have copied, whatever tool produced it. **Fix:** put any distinctive phrase in quotation marks in a search engine. If it returns many near-identical results, rewrite the sentence completely from your own understanding.

Passing AI text off as human writing

If a client is paying for original human writing — a speech, a personal statement, an article with a byline — producing machine text and calling it your own work is a misrepresentation, even if no one else has ever seen those words. **Fix:** tell the client what you use AI for, and price the human work you actually do.

How to make the work genuinely yours

1. **Rewrite from meaning, not from the sentence**
   Read the draft line, look away, and write the idea again in your own words. If the result is worse, your understanding of the fact is thin — go back to the source.
2. **Restructure**
   Change the order: put the price first, the story last. A different structure with the same facts is a different piece of writing.
3. **Add specifics only you have**
   The name of the actual street, the actual regular customer, the actual dish, the actual season. Machine text cannot contain what was never written down.
4. **Delete anything you cannot defend**
   Every sentence you keep should be one you could justify if the client asked "why did you write that?"

4.5 Confidentiality

NEVER PASTE THESE INTO A TOOL YOU DO NOT CONTROL

— A client's customer list, phone numbers, addresses or order history.

— Financial figures, bank details, wallet numbers, salaries or invoices.

— Unreleased products, pricing plans, tender documents or contract terms.

— Identity documents, licences, TIN certificates or anything with an ID number.

— Employee records, medical information or anything about a named individual.

— Anything a client has told you is private, whether or not they explained why.

Assume that anything you paste into a free tool may be stored, reviewed or used to improve a product. If you would not print it and leave it on a café table, do not paste it. Work with anonymised versions — "Customer A ordered 40 units" instead of the real name and number.

COPY-READY: MY CONFIDENTIALITY PROMISE TO CLIENTS

I treat everything you share with me as confidential. Your customer lists, prices, supplier details, financial information and any unpublished plans are used only to do the work you asked for, and are not shared with anyone else. I may use AI writing tools as part of producing a first draft, and I do not enter your customer data, financial figures, identity documents or unreleased plans into those tools — any such material is handled in anonymised form, for example "Customer A" instead of a name. Files are stored in a folder that only I can open, and I delete working files on request after the job is finished. If you would prefer that no AI tools are used on your work at all, tell me before we start and I will quote accordingly.

Give this paragraph to clients before the work starts, not after. It answers the question they are too polite to ask, and it separates you from people who never mention it.

4.6 Before you press send

THE PRE-SEND CHECKLIST

- [ ] Every number in the deliverable came from the client or a source I opened myself.
- [ ] Every name — business, person, place, product — is spelled as the client spells it.
- [ ] Every promise in the text is one the client can actually keep.
- [ ] Every date and time is confirmed, not assumed.
- [ ] Nothing is copied from another business's page or text.
- [ ] No customer data, financial figure or private document went into an AI tool.
- [ ] No sentence could describe a completely different business without being wrong.
- [ ] I have read the whole thing out loud, in order, without stopping.
- [ ] Any place I was unsure about is flagged in the delivery message as an open question.
- [ ] The file is named properly and opens correctly on a phone.
- [ ] The delivery message says what is included, what I checked and how revisions work.

SECTION 04 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Take the draft you produced at the end of Section 03. Run the pre-send checklist against it and count how many items you cannot tick. That number is the measure of how much real work remains before it is worth money.

05

SECTION FIVE

Editing So It Does Not Sound Like AI

The tells that make a reader suspect a machine wrote it, the rewrite rules that remove them, how to inject local truth the tool cannot know, one caption taken from generic to good, and the local language rule you must never break.

01 The tells

02 Eight rewrite rules

03 Injecting local truth

04 One caption, before and after

05 The the local language rule

06 The read-aloud test

Most people cannot name what is wrong with AI writing. They only feel that it is not theirs. That feeling is enough to stop them buying again.

This section is craft, not theory. It is the difference between text a client posts once and text a client comes back for.

5.1 The tells

These are the patterns that make a reader's eye skip. Learn to see them in your own drafts.

THE TELL	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHY IT FAILS
Generic opening	"In a city that never slows down…" / "When it comes to great coffee…"	It delays the information and says nothing about this business
Over-balanced sentences	"Not only fresh, but also affordable, and above all memorable."	Real speech is uneven. Perfectly balanced clauses read as manufactured
Empty adjectives	delicious, amazing, vibrant, authentic, premium, unforgettable	They carry no information. A price, a time or a place carries information
The rule-of-three with no specifics	"Quality, service and tradition."	Three abstract nouns in a row is the most common signature of machine text
The summary ending	"Whether you are… or …, there is something for everyone."	It closes a caption like an essay. A caption should end with an action or a fact
Borrowed grandeur	"A culinary journey", "a testament to craft", "where passion meets flavour"	Small businesses do not talk like this, and their customers know it
Symmetry across a whole set	Twelve captions all the same length, all opening with a verb	Readers notice repetition within a feed faster than within a page
Hedged claims	"one of the most popular", "widely regarded as", "many customers say"	Unsupported, and a competitor can challenge it. Remove it or prove it
Wrong register for the language	the local language that is grammatically possible but nobody says	It marks the writer as an outsider to every reader who speaks the language

> **THE ONE-SENTENCE TEST**
>
> Read a sentence and ask: **could this sentence appear, unchanged, on a competitor's page in another city?** If yes, it is not copy yet. It is filler that has been arranged neatly.

5.2 Eight rewrite rules

1. **Start with the fact, not the feeling**
   Replace "Start your day the right way" with "We open at 6:30. The first macchiato is poured at 6:35."

2. **Cut the first sentence entirely**
   AI drafts usually warm up for a sentence before saying anything. Delete it and read again. The piece almost always improves.

1. **Swap one adjective for one number**
   "Generous portions" becomes "the shiro comes with two injera". Numbers are specific, checkable and memorable.
1. **Break the symmetry**
   If three sentences in a row have the same length, make one of them four words. Rhythm is what makes writing sound human.
1. **Name a real thing**
   A street, a landmark, a dish, a season, a regular customer, a specific time of day. One real noun beats three adjectives.
2. **Write the way the owner speaks**
   Sit with the client for ten minutes and write down three phrases they actually use. Put one of them in the copy. It will sound like the business for the first time.
3. **End with an instruction or a fact**
   "Order before 11 for lunch delivery." "Closed Sunday." "Ask for the small size." Endings that do something beat endings that summarise.
4. **Delete every word you would not say out loud to a customer**
   Read the line to an imaginary customer standing in front of you. If you would not say it, cut it.

5.3 Injecting local truth

The tool has never been to the place. That is your advantage, and it is the fastest way to make any piece of copy impossible to copy.

Where to find local truth

- Stand outside the business for fifteen minutes and write down what you see.
- Photograph the menu, the price board and the signboard.
- Read the client's last twenty customer messages.
- Ask: "What do customers ask you most often?"
- Ask: "What time is the rush, and who comes?"
- Ask: "What do people get wrong about your business?"

What counts as local truth

- A real neighbourhood or landmark name.
- A real dish, drink or product with its real name.
- A real price.
- A real season or period that changes demand.
- A real customer moment: the 7 a.m. crowd, the exam-week rush, the Saturday family table.
- A real constraint the owner is proud of: "we only make forty a day".

DO NOT INVENT LOCAL COLOUR EITHER

Writing "just steps from a national holiday Square" when the shop is in Gerji is the same error as an invented statistic — it is a false specific. Local truth is only truth if you checked it. If you cannot visit, ask the client for a landmark, a photo of the street and the nearest known building.

5.4 One caption, before and after

Example scenario — fictional. The business is Riverside Coffee House, a fictional 20-seat café near the commercial district Medhanialem in your city.

Before — straight from the tool

"Start your day the right way at Riverside Coffee House! ☕ In today's fast-paced world, there's nothing quite like a perfectly crafted cup of coffee to set the tone for a productive morning. Whether you're a busy professional or a student, our cosy atmosphere and delicious menu offer something for everyone. Come and experience the perfect blend of tradition and modernity. Visit us today and let us make your morning unforgettable!"

Problems: generic opening, empty adjectives, rule-of-three, summary ending, no fact, no price, no time, no place detail, and it says nothing a hundred other cafés could not say.

After — edited for this café only

"Doors at 6:30. The macchiato is $0.40, the firfir is 180, and by 7 there is a queue of people who all want the same table. We close Sunday. the commercial district Medhanialem, opposite the pharmacy."

What changed: a time, two real prices, a real observation, a real closing day, a real landmark. Four facts a competitor cannot copy. Fifty-one words instead of ninety, and every one of them is checkable.

What the edit actually did

— Deleted the opening sentence completely rather than rewriting it.

— Replaced four adjectives with one price, one time and one day.

— Added one human observation the client confirmed was true — the 7 a.m. queue.

— Ended with a location, not a call to "experience" anything.

— Cut the length by more than half without losing a single idea.

THE RULE BEHIND THE EDIT

Every generic sentence you delete is worth more than any elegant sentence you add. Beginners add. Professionals cut.

5.5 The the local language rule

AI HANDLES THE LOCAL LANGUAGE UNEVENLY

Free AI chat tools handle the local language far less reliably than English. They produce text that is grammatically plausible and often unnatural: stiff phrasing, odd word order, terms nobody uses in that trade, and greetings that read as translated rather than written. Punctuation and spacing often need correction too.

Never publish the local language that has not been read by a fluent human. If you are not confident in the local language, either deliver only the English and say so clearly, or work with a named reviewer who is paid for the check. Do not deliver the local language you cannot verify — one awkward sentence will tell every reader that the business did not write it.

5.6 The read-aloud test

Before you send anything, read the whole deliverable out loud, in order, at normal speaking speed. This catches more problems than any checklist:

- [ ] Anywhere your voice stumbles is a sentence that needs rewriting.
- [ ] Anywhere you would feel foolish saying the words to a real customer, delete them.
- [ ] Anywhere two sentences say the same thing, cut one.
- [ ] Anywhere the piece sounds the same in the middle as at the start, vary the rhythm.
- [ ] Anywhere a fact appears that you did not verify, stop and check it.

READING ON A PHONE, WITH A SMALL BUNDLE

Read aloud from your notes app, not from the AI tool's page — long chat pages reload and cost data. Copy the final text into a note once, then do all your reading and editing offline. If you have no data at all, the editing stage still works: it is the one stage that needs nothing but you and the text.

SECTION 05 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Take the caption set you drafted in Section 03. Rewrite the first three captions using the eight rules, then read the whole set aloud. Compare the two versions before you delete the first one — seeing your own improvement is what makes the method stick.

06

SECTION SIX

Packaging and Pricing the Services

One-off work, packages and monthly retainers; the three-package ladder with worked USD examples; how to price for a client who has never bought this before; why a named monthly deliverable sells better than a general label; and five package descriptions you can adapt today.

01 One-off, package, monthly

02 The three-package ladder

03 Pricing a first-time buyer

04 Why the specific offer wins

05 Five package descriptions

06 Deposits, revisions and raising prices

A price is not a number you hope is acceptable. It is a statement about what you deliver, when, and how many times you will redo it.

Every figure in this section is an **example**, where you liven dollars, for a beginner with no portfolio in September 2026. Adjust to your market. None of it is a prediction of what you will earn.

6.1 One-off, package, monthly

One-off

What it is: a single defined job — ten product descriptions, one CV rewrite, one FAQ sheet.

Good for: a first job with a new client, testing whether you enjoy the work, and building a sample you are allowed to show.

Weakness: when it ends, your income ends. You must find another client.

Package

What it is: a bundle with a name, a quantity and a fixed price — "Starter: 8 captions, 2 revisions, 4 days".

Good for: making the decision simple. The client compares one price against one outcome instead of negotiating hourly.

Weakness: still a one-time sale.

Monthly

What it is: the same deliverable every month for a fixed fee — "12 captions a month, delivered by the 28th".

Good for: steady work, deeper knowledge of the client's business, and better copy each month.

Weakness: you must deliver on a date you chose, every month, including the month you are busy.

> **SELL THE MONTHLY VERSION WHENEVER YOU CAN**
>
> One client on a monthly package is worth more than three one-off jobs, because the work is predictable and the second month takes half the time of the first. Sell the one-off to prove yourself, then offer the monthly package in the same conversation you deliver the first job.

6.2 The three-package ladder

Three options, in this order, in every quote you send. Most clients choose the middle. The cheapest option exists so the middle one looks reasonable, and the top option exists so the middle one looks careful rather than expensive.

PACKAGE	WHAT IS INCLUDED	DELIVERY	EXAMPLE PRICE	WHO IT SUITS
Starter	8 captions, 1 revision round, hashtag set	3 days	$8	A shop testing whether social posting is worth the effort
Standard	12 captions, 1 short post image caption set, a 30-day posting calendar, 2 revision rounds	5 days	$15	A café, salon or boutique posting three or four times a week
Monthly	12 captions a month, a monthly calendar, 2 revision rounds, delivered by the 28th	Monthly	$12/month	A business that wants this handled permanently

Example prices only, for a beginner with no portfolio. They are illustrative, not standard rates for your country.

TARGET EXAMPLE — NOT A PREDICTION

```
2 monthly clients × $12 = $25 / month
+ 1 Standard package × $15 = $15
Monthly total if all three land: $6,400
```

This is arithmetic, not a forecast. Most beginners do not land three clients in their first month. The number is here so you can see how a small monthly figure is built, not so you can plan around it.

The same ladder for two other services

SERVICE	STARTER	STANDARD	MONTHLY OR LARGE
Product descriptions	5 items — $4	12 items with keywords — $10	Up to 30 items a month — $3,200
CV and cover letter	CV cleanup — $5	CV rewrite plus tailored letter — $11	CV, letter, and interview preparation — $2,600
FAQ and support scripts	10 FAQ answers — $6	20 FAQ answers plus 3 reply templates — $12	Monthly update of answers — $8/month
Research brief	Structure and question list — $6	3-page verified brief — $2,800	Brief plus a comparison table and presentation notes — $28

Example prices only. All figures are illustrative and where you liven dollars.

BEFORE YOU QUOTE A NUMBER, KNOW YOUR COST

Your costs are small but not zero: data, transport to meet a client, printing a sample, phone airtime, and your time. A freelancer's monthly data cost where you live has been reported as high as $19 for heavy use, though a text-first workflow costs a fraction of that. If your price leaves nothing after costs, you are working for free with extra steps.

6.3 Pricing a client who has never bought this before

Your client has never hired a caption writer. They have no idea what it costs, so they will compare your price to something they do know — a Facebook boost, a printed banner, or the salary of the person who currently does it badly in their spare time.

1. **Anchor to their existing spend, not to your hours**

   Ask what they currently pay for printing or promotion. If a banner costs them $16 and lasts a month, a 12-post month at $12 is easy to justify and easy to understand.

2. **Quote in deliverables, never in hours**

   "Twelve captions and a calendar for $15" is a decision. "Ten hours at $240" is a negotiation about whether you are slow.

1. **Give three options, always**

   Starter, Standard, Monthly. A client choosing between three of your packages is not comparing you with someone else.

1. **Ask for half up front on anything over $12**
   Onboarding, deposit, then delivery. Explain it plainly: "Half to start, half on delivery." Most established businesses expect this and respect it.
1. **Never discount without removing something**
   If they cannot pay 2,400, offer 8 captions for 1,600. Lowering the price for the same deliverable teaches the client that your first number was invented.
1. **Hold your price for the first three clients**
   Charge the same to everyone for your first three jobs. It makes your quote sound like a price rather than an opening bid.

6.4 Why the specific offer wins

"I do AI copywriting" is not an offer. It is a category, and the client has to invent the job for you. Compare:

WHAT YOU SAY	WHAT THE CLIENT HEARS
"I do AI content and copywriting."	"I do not know what I would get, how long it takes or what it costs."
"Captions for 12 posts a month, delivered by the 28th, $12."	"I know exactly what arrives, when, and what it costs."
"I help businesses grow with digital marketing."	"This person is about to sell me advertising I did not ask for."
"Ten product descriptions for your a local classifieds site and Telegram listings, with keywords, $1,400, two days."	"This solves the thing I have been avoiding for three weeks."

The specific offer also protects you. When the deliverable is twelve captions, "can you also do a poster?" becomes a new job with a new price, not an argument.

6.5 Five package descriptions you can adapt

Send these as text, or write them onto a single sheet. Replace every bracketed part. All five describe fictional example offers.

PACKAGE 1 — THE CAFÉ CAPTION MONTH

Twelve posts, one month, handled. Twelve ready-to-post captions for [Instagram and Telegram], a set of hashtags for each, and a simple calendar showing which post goes out on which day.

Built from your real menu — your dishes, your prices, your opening hours, your neighbourhood.

What I need from you: a photo of your menu, your opening hours, and ten minutes to ask a few questions about your busiest times.

Delivery: five working days. **Includes:** two rounds of changes. **Price:** [2,400] USD.

PACKAGE 2 — THE ONLINE SELLER PRODUCT PACK

Twelve product descriptions, written to sell. For each item: a title under 60 characters, a short description, five bullet points and eight search keywords, formatted the same way for every item so your shop looks consistent.

Built from your actual product details — materials, sizes, colours, prices. I do not invent specifications.

What I need from you: a list of the items with their details and prices, and photos if you have them.

Delivery: three working days. **Price:** [1,600] USD for twelve items.

PACKAGE 3 — THE CV AND COVER LETTER SET

A CV that reads clearly, and a letter written for one specific job. You receive a rewritten CV in a clean format, one tailored cover letter for a role you choose, and a short note explaining what I changed and why.

I do not add anything you have not done. Every job, date and qualification stays exactly as you gave it. What changes is the order and the wording.

What I need from you: your current CV, and the job advertisement or the type of role you are applying for.

Delivery: two working days. **Includes:** one round of changes. **Price:** [1,800] USD.

PACKAGE 4 — THE FAQ AND REPLY TEMPLATES

Stop answering the same twelve questions. I turn the questions your customers actually send into a clean FAQ sheet of [20] answers, three ready-made reply templates, and a one-page rule sheet for when to answer, when to ask you, and what never to promise in writing.

Built from your real messages and your real policies — delivery, payment, returns, hours.

What I need from you: screenshots or a copy of recent customer questions, and your answers to the ones you have not decided yet.

Delivery: three working days. **Price:** [2,000] USD.

PACKAGE 5 — THE SHORT RESEARCH BRIEF

A three-page brief before you spend money. You describe the decision you are facing — a new product line, a new location, a supplier, a price change — and you receive a structured brief: what to check, a comparison table, the questions you should be able to answer, and a list of what I could not confirm.

Every figure in the brief is sourced or clearly marked as unconfirmed. If I cannot verify something, it appears as an open question rather than a number.

What this is not: a guarantee, a market forecast, or financial advice.

Delivery: four working days. **Price:** [2,800] USD.

6.6 Deposits, revisions and raising prices

Revisions

Two rounds are included in a standard package. Define a round clearly: *one set of written changes sent in a single message*. Ten separate voice notes sent over three days is not one round, and you should say so politely the first time it happens.

The first round should always be free of argument — if you made an error, fixing it is not a favour. The third round onward is new work at a stated rate.

Deposits

For anything above about $12, ask for half in advance. For new clients who found you online and you have never met, ask for the full amount on small jobs or half on larger ones. This is normal commercial practice, not distrust.

State it before you start: "*Half to begin, half on delivery.*" Clients who refuse any deposit on a first job are usually the clients who do not pay at the end.

When to raise your price

— After three completed jobs delivered on time, raise your next quote by 20–30%.

— When a job that used to take four hours now takes two, your price should not fall — your experience is the product.

— Raise prices for **new** clients first. Keep existing clients at their rate for one more cycle, then tell them in advance.

— Re-check your own prices once a year. local education inflation ran at 25.3% year on year in August 2026 and headline inflation at 15.1%; a price that never moves is a price that shrinks.

SECTION 06 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Write your three packages — Starter, Standard and Monthly — for your one chosen service, with a price and a delivery time for each. Save them as a note you can paste into a chat. You will use this text in almost every conversation from Section 08 onwards.

07

SECTION SEVEN

Finding Buyers

Prospecting as a weekly discipline rather than a mood: using Google Maps by Addis district and category, a local classifieds site, the online business directory, the online business directory, online sellers, Telegram shop owners and small exporters — plus how the same method works in a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and a regional city.

01 Prospecting is a discipline

02 The five surfaces that work today

03 your city: the ten sub-cities

04 Beyond Addis

05 Building a list of 30

06 The worked example sheet

Nobody is waiting for you. That is not a reason to stop; it is the reason prospecting is a weekly habit with a number attached rather than something you do when you feel brave.

This section gives you five real surfaces where small local businesses are listed today, an exact search routine, and the spreadsheet that turns a list of names into a list of clients.

7.1 Prospecting is a discipline

Set one number and keep it: **twenty new prospects researched and added to your sheet each week, and five first messages sent each week.** If you only have weekends, do all twenty on Saturday and send the five messages on Sunday evening and Monday morning.

30	5	3
PROSPECTS ON YOUR LIST	FIRST MESSAGES A WEEK	FOLLOW-UPS EACH

Expect most messages to go unanswered. That is normal in every country and every industry. What matters is that the five messages go out every week regardless of how the previous week felt.

FILTER FOR BUSINESSES THAT ARE ACTUALLY TRADING

More than 80% of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025. Many listings you find will belong to businesses that no longer operate. Before you add a prospect, check three things: the page has posted in the last 30 days, a phone number answers or a Telegram handle is active, and the prices or menu are current. A live prospect list of 30 beats a dead list of 300.

7.2 The five surfaces that work today

01 Google Maps and Business Profiles

Your primary tool. Search a category plus a neighbourhood — "café the commercial district", "boutique the eastern district", "dental clinic the central district". Open each result and note: is there a description? Are the hours filled in? Are there photos from this year? Are there unanswered reviews? Google Business Profiles are officially supported where you live, so the profile itself is a real surface a business can improve.

02 a local classifieds site

Live classifieds with USD prices. Browse Services and Business & Industry, filter by Addis district, and look at sellers with many listings and thin descriptions. A seller with 40 listings and one line of text per item is a product-description client waiting to happen.

03 an online business directory

A category directory with counts and a city filter. Roughly 30 categories, including Import & Export (2,784 listings), Professional Services (2,058), Factories (1,186), Construction (956) and Restaurants & Cafes (257), across 14 cities. Use the city filter for a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and the rest.

04 an online business directory

More than 10,000 companies listed, and businesses can add themselves free. Useful for finding importers, manufacturers and professional services firms that need export-facing English copy.

05 — the surfaces nobody lists

— **Telegram shop channels.** Join channels selling clothing, shoes, cosmetics, electronics and food in your city. Look at how the posts are written. Three lines and a price with no description is your opening.

— **Instagram and Facebook business pages** with a phone number and no website link.

— **Small exporters.** Coffee, oilseeds, pulses, leather goods and spices sellers who write to foreign buyers in English. Search the online business directory import/export category and look for pages with rough English — that roughness is exactly what you are being paid to fix.

— **Association and chamber member lists.** Around twelve chambers and six associations publish member lists with phone numbers. These are useful for reaching many businesses through one introduction, not as a prospect list on their own.

— **Physical observation.** Walk one commercial street, note every business with a handwritten price list and no printed one. That street is a prospect list you can build in an hour without any data.

WHAT NOT TO DO

Do not attempt to build an online marketplace or directory. A study of local e-commerce platforms found that more than half earn under USD 10,000 a year. Selling a service to existing businesses is a much shorter road to a first payment than building a platform for them.

7.3 your city: search by district

The ten sub-cities have different commercial characters. Use them as your search filters, and vary them week by week instead of searching "your city" and getting lost.

SUB-CITY	WHAT TO SEARCH	WHO IS USUALLY THERE
the commercial district	café, boutique, guest house, dental clinic, travel agency, gym	Businesses with budgets and an existing English-speaking audience; the most competitive list, so your sample must be good
the central district	restaurant, clothing shop, electronics, printing press, driving school	A dense mix of trade and services, many with active Facebook pages and weak descriptions
the eastern district	tutoring centre, kindergarten, bakery, pharmacy, mini-market	Growing residential demand; owners often handle their own posting and have no time for it
the old town	jewellery, leather goods, bookshop, traditional restaurant, tour operator	Heritage and tourism businesses that need English copy for foreign visitors
the northern district	workshop, spare parts, furniture maker, small factory, fitness centre	Makers and repair businesses that sell through word of mouth and have no written product descriptions at all

SUB-CITY	WHAT TO SEARCH	WHO IS USUALLY THERE
the western district	construction supplier, real estate office, car dealer, restaurant, salon	Larger premises and larger budgets; slower to decide, better paying when they do
the outer district	garment workshop, food processing, transport company, hardware	Production businesses that need export-facing or buyer-facing English documents
the industrial district	factory, warehouse, agro-processing, packaging supplier	Industrial clients with the least online presence and the clearest need for written materials

SUB-CITY	WHAT TO SEARCH	WHO IS USUALLY THERE
the market district	handicraft, textile shop, small hotel, clinic, catering	Small businesses with strong products and weak written presentation

SUB-CITY	WHAT TO SEARCH	WHO IS USUALLY THERE
the busiest district	wholesale, import trade, electronics, fabric shop, stationery	High-volume traders who need product listings and buyer emails more than they need social posts

Sub-city names as used in your city. What you find in each will change; treat this as a starting search pattern, not a fixed description.

7.4 Beyond Addis

The method is identical outside the capital, and competition for this work is thinner. What changes is the client type and how you reach them.

CITY	WHO TENDS TO NEED THIS WORK	WHERE TO LOOK
a regional city	Hotels and guest houses on the lake road, tour operators, coffee and honey producers, colleges	Google Maps by area, the online business directory city filter, hotel Facebook pages, Telegram groups for the city
a regional city	Coffee exporters and washing stations, fish restaurants, hotels, event organisers	an online business directory Import & Export listings, Google Maps around the lake shore, local business Telegram channels
a regional city	Tutoring centres, clinics, import traders, universities and training institutes, reconstruction suppliers	an online business directory and an online business directory city listings, Facebook pages, noticeboards at colleges
a regional city	Import and export traders, logistics and transport firms, wholesalers, hotels	an online business directory Import & Export, a local classifieds site, the chamber of commerce member list
a regional city	Manufacturers, flower and agro businesses, transport companies, restaurants on the highway	an online business directory Factories category, an online business directory, industrial park contacts
a regional city	Coffee cooperatives and unions, colleges, clinics, hotels	an online business directory city filter, cooperative union pages, Google Maps around the town centre
a regional city	Tour operators, guest houses, handicraft sellers, restaurants serving visitors	Google Maps by landmark, tour operator websites with poor English, Facebook tourism pages

THE REGIONAL ADVANTAGE

In a smaller city you can be the only person offering this. You also know things a writer in Addis does not: which season brings visitors, which market day is busiest, which dish the town is known for. Use that knowledge in the sample you send. It is the reason a business will reply to you instead of to a stranger from the capital.

7.5 Building a list of 30

Thirty live prospects, researched properly, is roughly two weeks of work at ten a day — or one focused weekend. Do it in this order:

1. **Choose one category and two neighbourhoods**

   For example: cafés in the commercial district and the eastern district. Narrow beats broad. You will learn what a good café caption looks like by the tenth one.

1. **Search and open twenty results per neighbourhood**

   Google Maps first. Note the business name, phone number, district, whether they have a website, and whether their page has posted in the last 30 days.

1. **Write one specific observation per business**

   Not "needs better marketing" — that is useless. Write: "*menu photos from 2023, no prices shown, last post four months ago, 12 unanswered reviews.*" That sentence becomes the first line of your outreach message.

1. **Score them and cut**

   Keep the ones that are trading, posting occasionally, and clearly trying. Cut the ones that closed, the chains with an agency, and anyone whose page shows they already employ a content person.

2. **Add a contact route and a status column**

   Telegram handle, phone number, Instagram DM, or an email from their own website. Then track every message you send and every reply.

7.6 The worked example sheet

Columns for your sheet. Keep it to these eight; more columns mean you stop filling it in.

COLUMN 1
Business name
Exactly as it appears on their page.

COLUMN 2
Category and district
Café — the eastern district.

COLUMN 3
Contact route
Telegram handle, phone, or DM.

COLUMN 4
What I noticed
One specific, checkable observation.

COLUMN 5
Service I will offer
One service, one quantity.

COLUMN 6
First contact date
The date you actually sent it.

COLUMN 7
Follow-up dates
Three follow-ups, spaced.

COLUMN 8
Status
Sent / replied / quoted / won / no.

Five filled rows, as an example of the level of detail that works. **Example scenarios — fictional.**

BUSINESS (FICTIONAL)	CATEGORY AND AREA	CONTACT ROUTE	WHAT I NOTICED	SERVICE I WILL OFFER	STATUS
Riverside Coffee House	Café — the commercial district	Instagram DM, phone on page	Last post four months ago; menu photos are from 2023; no prices shown; 12 unanswered reviews	Starter: 8 captions, $8, 3 days	Sample sent
Lakeview Style House	Clothing — a regional city	Telegram channel admin	40 items listed with three words each and no sizes; prices inconsistent between posts	Standard: 12 product descriptions, $10, 3 days	Quoted

BUSINESS (FICTIONAL)	CATEGORY AND AREA	CONTACT ROUTE	WHAT I NOTICED	SERVICE I WILL OFFER	STATUS
a regional city Bright Path Tutorial Centre	Tutoring — a regional city	Facebook page phone number	Parents ask the same five questions in comments; no FAQ anywhere; enrolment message is one line long	FAQ sheet plus 3 reply templates, $12, 3 days	Replied, wants a call

BUSINESS (FICTIONAL)	CATEGORY AND AREA	CONTACT ROUTE	WHAT I NOTICED	SERVICE I WILL OFFER	STATUS
Highland Tour Link	Tour operator — a regional city	Website contact form	English page has awkward phrasing and no prices; two tour descriptions say "contact us" only	Home and About page copy, $19, 4 days	First follow-up sent
a regional city Agro Supply	Agro-processing — a regional city	an online business directory listing phone number	Exports to two buyers; English product sheet is a scanned handwritten page	Export product sheet, $2,800, 4 days	Not contacted yet

All five businesses above are fictional examples written for teaching. Any resemblance to a real business is coincidental. Prices are examples only.

SECTION 07 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Build the sheet today with ten rows. Ten is enough to start. Do not wait for thirty before you send your first message — the first reply will teach you more about your offer than another twenty rows of research.

08

SECTION EIGHT

Selling It: Outreach, Samples and the Free-Sample Trap

How to build a one-piece sample that proves your value without giving away a project, the exact outreach scripts for first contact, two follow-ups, a price reply and a refusal, and the rule that limits free work to one small piece per prospect.

01 The sample that proves value

02 The free-sample trap

03 The exact scripts

04 Answering the six replies you will get

05 Referrals

You are not asking for a favour. You are offering a supplier relationship, and the message should read that way: short, specific, and easy to answer.

Every script in this section is copy-ready. Replace the bracketed parts, keep the length, and send.

8.1 The sample that proves value

A sample is not a portfolio. A portfolio says "here is work I did". A sample says "here is what I would do for *you*". The second one gets replies.

How to build a one-piece sample

1. Pick one prospect from your sheet.
2. Open their page and find one real, specific gap — a missing price, a four-month-old post, a menu from 2023.
3. Produce **one small piece**: three captions, one product description, one FAQ answer, one rewritten About paragraph.
4. Use only facts from their own page. Do not invent a price, a dish or a service.
5. Label it clearly: "*Sample — written by [your name] for [business], not for publication. If you do not want it, tell me and I will delete it.*"
6. Send it with the first outreach message. No attachment if the connection is slow — paste it as text in the message body.

Why it works

It costs you under an hour, it uses nothing private, and it removes the client's biggest question: "*what would I actually get?*"

It also proves you looked. Ninety percent of the messages a business owner receives are copied and pasted. A message containing a detail from their own page — the specific dish, the specific gap, the specific street — is instantly recognisable as written for them.

Storage and data: save samples in one folder and keep a text version in your notes app. Sending text costs almost nothing; sending a large image file on a weak connection wastes your bundle and may not arrive.

8.2 The free-sample trap

THE RULE: ONE SMALL PIECE PER PROSPECT, EVER

Give each prospect **one small sample, once**. Never a full project. Never a second sample "to show what the full set would look like". Never "I will do the first month free and you pay if you like it".

A full free project teaches the client that your work has no price. It also attracts the small number of people who collect free work from beginners and never pay anyone. If a prospect asks for more before paying, the correct answer is the price reply in 8.3.

Acceptable free work

— 3 captions for one prospect

— 1 product description

— 1 rewritten paragraph

— 1 FAQ answer

— A one-paragraph critique of their current page

Not acceptable

— A whole month of captions

— The full 12-product list

— A complete website

— Work for three prospects "to compare"

— Anything requiring client data or a login

Where the line sits

Free work should be **small enough to lose and specific enough to be impressive**. If losing it would upset you, it is too big. If it could have been written for any café in the city, it is too generic.

8.3 The exact scripts

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE (TELEGRAM, INSTAGRAM DM OR SMS)

Selam [owner's name], my name is [your name]. I write post captions for cafés in [city or district].

I looked at your page. You have [specific observation: menu photos from 2023 and no prices shown on the last six posts]. That is the first thing a new customer checks.

I wrote three captions using only your own menu and prices, as a sample. They are below. Use them or delete them, either is fine.

[Paste the three captions.]

If they are useful, I do twelve captions and a posting calendar for [2,400] dollars, delivered in five days. If not, no problem at all — and if you would rather I did not message again, say so and I will stop.

— [your name], [phone or Telegram handle]

COPY-READY: FOLLOW-UP ONE (THREE DAYS LATER)

Selam [name], following up briefly on the captions I sent on [day].

One thing I noticed since then: [new, specific, useful observation — for example, three people asked your price in the comments and nobody answered]. That is the kind of question the captions and the calendar are meant to reduce.

No pressure. If it is not the right time, tell me and I will check back in [two months].

COPY-READY: FOLLOW-UP TWO (SEVEN DAYS AFTER THAT), THE LAST ONE

Selam [name], this is my last message about the captions so I do not clutter your inbox.

If you ever want the twelve captions and the calendar, the offer stands at [2,400] dollars and takes five days. If you would like me to look at something else instead — product descriptions, or an FAQ for the questions you keep answering — say the word.

Either way, I wish you a good [month or season]. — [your name]

COPY-READY: THE PRICE REPLY, WHEN THEY ASK "HOW MUCH?"

Thanks for asking. Here are the three options:

Starter — [1,200] **dollars:** [8] captions with hashtags, delivered in three days, one round of changes.

Standard — [2,400] **dollars:** [12] captions, a 30-day posting calendar, delivered in five days, two rounds of changes.

Monthly — [2,000] **dollars per month:** [12] captions every month, delivered by the [28th], two rounds of changes each month.

For anything above $12 I ask half to start and half on delivery. Everything is written from your own menu, prices and hours — I do not invent dishes, prices or offers. Which one sounds closest to what you need?

COPY-READY: "WE ALREADY HAVE SOMEONE"

That is good to hear — a business with someone handling its page is a business that takes it seriously.

Two things I can offer without replacing anyone: **overflow**, when there is a busy week or a campaign and they need extra pieces; and a **second pair of eyes** on the English before anything goes out, at [500] dollars per batch of ten posts.

If neither is useful now, may I check back in [three months]? And if you know one other owner in [category] who is struggling with this, I would be grateful for an introduction.

COPY-READY: THE REFERRAL ASK, AFTER A JOB IS DELIVERED WELL

Thank you for the work — the [12 captions] are delivered and the payment is confirmed.

One small favour, only if it is easy: do you know one other business owner who posts on [Instagram or Telegram] and does not have time for it? If you introduce me by name in a message, I will look at their page and send them one sample, the same way I did for you. If it turns into work, I will give you [10] percent of the first job as a thank-you.

8.4 The six replies you will get

WHAT THEY SAY	WHAT IT USUALLY MEANS	WHAT TO REPLY
"Send me your price list."	Genuine interest, no time to talk	The three-option price reply above, ending with a question so the conversation continues
"We will think about it."	Not convinced, or no budget this month	Agree, then ask one question: "Which part is uncertain — the price, the timing, or whether captions help at all?"
"It is too expensive."	Comparing to nothing, or genuinely tight	Offer the smaller package at a lower price with fewer deliverables. Never cut the price for the same work
"Can you do it for free first?"	Testing you, or collecting free work	"I already sent one sample. If it is close to what you want, the Starter package is [1,200] dollars and I start today."
"How do I know it will work?"	A fair question with no honest guarantee	"I cannot promise sales. What I can promise is twelve captions built from your real menu and prices, delivered on [date], with two rounds of changes. If the first month does not fit how you talk about the place, I will rewrite them."
Nothing at all	The most common outcome	Two follow-ups, spaced, then stop. Move to the next prospect and check back in two or three months

HOW MANY MESSAGES IS NORMAL

Assume you will need to contact many businesses for each one that pays. Nobody can tell you the exact number, and anyone who quotes you a conversion rate is inventing it. What you control is the weekly count: **five first messages and five follow-ups every week, without exception, for six weeks.** That is the discipline, and it is the whole difference between readers who find clients and readers who do not.

8.5 Referrals: the cheapest client you will ever get

After every delivered job, ask one question: "*Do you know one other owner who would find this useful?*" A named introduction works far better than a cold message, because you arrive already vouched for.

— Ask at the moment of delivery, when the client is satisfied and the work is visible.

— Ask for a name, not for a general favour. "Do you know one person?" gets a name. "Tell people about me" gets nothing.

— Offer something concrete in return — a percentage of the first job, or a free extra piece on their next order.

— Ask satisfied clients for a written line you can quote. Never write the testimonial yourself and ask them to sign it.

SECTION 08 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Open your prospect sheet, pick the top three rows, and build one sample for each — three captions, one product description, one FAQ answer. Send all three first messages this week. Then read Section 09 so you know what to do when someone says yes.

09

SECTION NINE

Delivery, Payment and the Business Around It

The onboarding, scope, delivery and revision messages that prevent arguments; a simple file-naming convention; how local clients actually pay an individual; what a merchant gateway requires; the verified route for foreign clients; and the four things you must never do with money.

01 The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

02 Local clients versus international clients

03 The legitimate routes, in order

04 What never to do

05 Tax and registration, honestly

Most disputes between a beginner and a client are not about quality. They are about a promise nobody wrote down.

This section is the paperwork that makes you look and behave like a supplier. It takes forty minutes to set up and it will save you far more than that.

Getting Paid for AI-Assisted Work

This is the chapter that decides whether the rest of the book turns into money. It is also the chapter most online advice gets wrong, because most online advice assumes you live in a country with a full set of payment rails. If you do, the short version is at the end of this section. If you do not, the rest of this section is for you.

> **THE ONE RULE THAT PREVENTS ALMOST EVERY PROBLEM**
>
> **Agree the payment route with the client before you agree the price.** Not after the work is done, not in the invoice, not when they ask for your bank details. Before.
>
> A client who cannot pay you the way you need is not a client. They are a conversation. Finding that out on delivery day is the most expensive lesson in this book, and it is entirely avoidable with one question asked early.

How money actually crosses a border

When a client in another country pays you, the money does not travel directly. It moves through a chain, and every link in that chain is a place where it can stop. Knowing the chain tells you which question to ask.

1. **The client pays something**
   A card, a PayPal balance, a bank transfer, a mobile wallet, a local payment method. What they can use depends on *their* country, not yours.

2. **A processor authorises it**
   Stripe, PayPal, Adyen, a regional gateway. This is where most cross-border problems originate, because processors operate country by country.

3. **A platform holds it**
   If you sell through a marketplace or course platform, they hold the money and pay you later, on their schedule, at their minimum.

4. **It is paid out to you**
   A bank deposit in your local currency, a PayPal transfer, or a wallet credit. **This is the link that fails most often**, and it is the one nobody checks before they start.

EXPLAIN Buyer-side and seller-side are independent. What your client can use to pay has nothing to do with what you can receive. A platform can be perfectly good for your buyers and completely useless for paying you.

SHOW *Example — fictional.* A writer in Nairobi sells a $25 template pack. Buyers pay by card without difficulty. The platform's payout page then shows one option: PayPal. The writer's PayPal account can send but cannot receive. Fourteen sales, $350, stuck behind a payout route that was never tested.

DO Before you build anything, open the payout settings of every platform you are considering and write down, in one sentence, exactly how money would reach your bank account.

CHECK Can you name the rail, the currency, the minimum payout and the delay? If any of those four is a guess, you have not finished checking.

The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

Do this once per platform. It takes about twenty minutes and it prevents weeks of wasted work.

QUESTION	WHERE TO LOOK	WHAT A USABLE ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
1. Does this platform pay out to my country?	The platform's own payout-settings page or help article — never a blog post, never a YouTube video	Your country named on the platform's own list, with the payout currency
2. Through which rail?	The same page	A named method: local bank deposit, PayPal, Payoneer, wallet. "Contact support" is not an answer
3. What is the minimum and the delay?	The payout help article	A number and a schedule, so you can plan cash flow
4. What does it cost in total?	The pricing page *and* the fees help article — they often disagree	Platform fee plus processing fee, added together, expressed as a percentage of a typical sale

TWO RULES THAT WILL SAVE YOU MONEY

Read the payout page, not the signup page. Almost every platform lets you sign up from almost anywhere. That tells you nothing. The gate is payout.

Check whether two platforms share a rail. If two services both pay through the same underlying processor, they are not backups of each other. When that one rail has a problem, both stop at once. Verify the underlying rail, not just the brand on the front.

Local clients versus international clients

These are two different problems and they need two different answers. Do not let one delay the other.

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
What works	Bank transfer, mobile wallet, cash, a local card gateway. Almost always available to an individual with no registered business.	A licensed remittance corridor, a platform that pays out to your country, or an employer's own payroll route.
Speed	Same day, often same hour	Days to weeks, depending on the platform's payout schedule
What can block it	Nothing much, if you have an account in your own name	Country eligibility, missing documents, a rail that does not reach you
Best first move	Start here. Local clients pay for your proof.	Test the payout route with a small real payment before you promise anything

THE TEST PAYMENT

Before you quote a single international client, run one small real transaction end to end: sell something cheap — a $5 template, a $10 review, a single small job — and take it all the way to money in your account.

This costs you one afternoon and one small fee. It converts every assumption in this chapter into a fact, and it is the single most useful hour in this entire book.

What to say to a client about payment

Clients are not suspicious of payment questions. They are suspicious of vague ones. Say the route plainly, in the first conversation, in writing.

COPY-READY: THE PAYMENT-ROUTING MESSAGE

Before we start, one practical thing so neither of us has a surprise at the end.

I am paid by `[route: bank transfer / a named platform / a licensed transfer service]`. The money arrives in `[currency]`, and I can start work as soon as the first payment shows on my side.

If you would rather use a different method, tell me now and I will check whether it works — I would rather spend five minutes on this today than a week on it later.

For `[amount]` the split is `[50]`% to start and `[50]`% on delivery.

COPY-READY: WHEN A PAYMENT IS LATE

Hello `[name]` — checking in on the `[amount]` for `[work]`, which I sent on `[date]`. It has not shown on my side yet.

Could you confirm the date it was sent and the reference number? If it has not gone out yet, no problem — just let me know when it will, and I will plan around that.

Pricing when the route costs money

Cross-border routes cost the sender or the receiver money. Decide who absorbs it before you quote, and put it in the price rather than discovering it later.

WORKED EXAMPLE — TARGET ARITHMETIC, NOT A FORECAST

```
Your price for the work: $100
Transfer or platform cost, if you absorb it: $5–$15
What actually reaches you: $85–$95
```

Two ways to handle it: quote a price that already includes the cost, or state plainly that transfer fees are the sender's. What you must not do is quote $100 and then argue about $12 after delivery.

NEVER DO THESE THINGS, WHATEVER ANYONE TELLS YOU

— **Never enter a false country, name or address** on a payment platform. It breaches the provider's terms, it usually fails identity verification anyway, and the consequence is a frozen balance and a closed account — with your customers refunded and your earnings gone.

— **Never use a relative's or friend's account abroad** to receive money that is yours. It is the same misrepresentation with extra steps, and it puts their account at risk too.

— **Never use a VPN to open a financial account** in a country you do not live in.

— **Never buy or rent a verified account.** The seller keeps access to it.

— **Never accept payment in a form your country restricts.** Several countries prohibit or restrict virtual-asset transactions; check your own before you accept anything unusual.

The published terms are unambiguous about this. Most platforms require you not to "create an account using a false identity or information, or on behalf of someone other than yourself", and prohibit misrepresenting your "identity, location or credentials". The stated remedy is suspension or termination, and where an underlying processor makes the final call it is often not appealable.

The legitimate routes, in the order worth trying

#	ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO VERIFY FIRST
1	A platform that publishes your country on its own payout list, paying into a local bank account in local currency	Anyone selling digital products or courses	That the payout page offers *bank deposit*, not "PayPal only", for your country
2	A licensed money-transfer service (Western Union, MoneyGram, Remitly, WorldRemit and similar) for a one-off client payment	Freelancers and service sellers with a single client	That the receiving country and currency appear on the provider's own corridor list
3	An employer's own payroll or contractor route	Remote employees and long-term contractors	That the employer has paid a contractor in your country before — ask them directly
4	Registering as an exporter of services and receiving into a foreign-currency account	Anyone earning regularly from abroad	Your own country's rules. In several countries this unlocks full retention of foreign-currency earnings and an international card — ask a local accountant, do not guess
5	Trading through a properly registered company in the country where the payout account sits	Established sellers doing meaningful volume	Real incorporation, a real bank account there, real accounting, and any home-country approval required. Legitimate, but slow and expensive — not a shortcut

IF YOU ALREADY HAVE FULL PAYMENT RAILS

Then most of this chapter is not your constraint, and your fastest route is whatever your clients already use: Stripe, PayPal, a card gateway. Skim the four verification questions above anyway — the platform fee difference between two similar services is often several percentage points, and on a hundred sales a year that is real money.

Tax and registration, stated honestly

THIS IS NOT TAX ADVICE, AND THE RULES ARE LOCAL

Almost every country requires you to declare income you earn, and most require some form of tax registration once you are trading. What that means in practice — a tax number, a business registration, a turnover-tax threshold, a VAT threshold — differs enormously from country to country, and the thresholds change.

What to do: find your national tax authority's own website, look for the page on registering as a sole trader or self-employed person, and read the current threshold. If your earnings are small, you may be below every threshold. If they are not, register. A local accountant charges very little for one hour of advice, and that hour is worth more than any general guidance in a book written for the whole world.

Keep a simple record from your first sale: date, client, amount, currency, what it was for, and the fee deducted. That one sheet makes tax time trivial and makes you look professional if anyone ever asks.

IF YOU SELL THROUGH A MARKETPLACE, READ THIS

Large platforms are often the *merchant of record*, meaning they handle sales tax and VAT for the buyer and remit it themselves. That does not remove your obligation to declare the income you receive. It changes what you have to collect, not whether you have to report.

Some platforms also require a tax form before they will pay you at all — a W-9 if you are in the United States, a W-8 series form if you are not, or a local equivalent. If a form is required and not submitted, payouts are usually paused. Complete it early rather than after your first sale.

10

SECTION TEN

A 14-Day Implementation Plan

Fourteen days, one service, one real client conversation. Each day has an objective, a task, a concrete example, an output you can point at, and a check that tells you whether it is finished.

01 How to use the plan

02 Days 1–5: choose, learn, prepare

03 Days 6–10: build the list and make contact

04 Days 11–14: deliver, get paid, repeat

Fourteen days is long enough to go from nothing to a paid job, and short enough that you cannot postpone it indefinitely. Work 45–60 minutes a day.

If you miss a day, continue where you stopped. Do not restart the plan, and do not skip the verification days.

10.1 How to use this plan

One service only

Everything in this plan assumes you picked one service in Section 01. If you have not chosen, choose before Day 1.

Outputs, not reading

Each day produces something you can point at: a note, a sheet, a sample, a sent message, a delivered file.

Phone-first

Every task can be done on a phone. Days 5 and 9 are easier with a laptop, but both have a phone alternative.

WHAT THIS PLAN CANNOT PROMISE

Completing fourteen days does not guarantee a sale, a client or any income. It guarantees that you will have a defined service, a price, a sample, a prospect list and a set of sent messages. Those are the inputs you control. The outcome also depends on the market, the season and luck.

DAY 01 Choose the service and write the offer

OBJECTIVE Commit to one service in writing so every later day has a target.

TASK Read Section 01 if you have not. Pick one of the twelve services. Write a single sentence describing exactly what a client receives, with a quantity, a price in dollars and a delivery time.

EXAMPLE "Twelve Instagram and Telegram captions built from your real menu and prices, plus a 30-day posting calendar, $15, five working days."

OUTPUT One sentence saved in a note called `offer`.

CHECK

- [ ] It names a quantity, a price and a delivery time
- [ ] It does not mention AI at all
- [ ] A stranger could repeat it back to you correctly

DAY 02 Learn the workflow and copy the templates

OBJECTIVE Understand the six stages well enough to explain them without the book.

TASK Read Section 02. Copy the brief template, the master prompt and the "fix this" prompt into your notes app. Fill in the brief for one real business you know.

EXAMPLE A filled brief for Riverside Coffee House (fictional example) listing the menu, prices, hours, the target customer and the fact that the closing day is not yet confirmed.

OUTPUT A completed brief for one real business, plus three saved templates.

CHECK

- [ ] Every line of the brief is filled or marked as unknown
- [ ] You can name all six stages in order from memory

DAY 03 Build your prompt set

OBJECTIVE Have four to six prompts that reliably produce a usable first draft for your service.

TASK From Section 03, copy the prompts for your service. Run each one once on the real business from Day 2, using facts you are certain about. Keep the output that is closest to usable.

EXAMPLE The caption-set prompt returns twelve lines; you keep it and add one rule line: "Do not use the words delicious, perfect or vibe."

OUTPUT A note called `prompts` with your service prompts, each improved by one rule you added yourself.

CHECK

- [ ] Each prompt names a role, a task, an audience, a format and a length
- [ ] Each prompt ends with a rule against inventing facts

DAY 04 Learn to verify and catch hallucinations

OBJECTIVE Be able to spot a plausible-but-wrong claim before a client does.

TASK Read Section 04. Take yesterday's output and mark every number, name, date and promise. For each one, write where it came from. Then ask the tool to list the claims it added itself, and see whether the two lists match.

EXAMPLE The draft says "open every day". You mark it, check with the owner, and find out the café closes Sunday. The line is deleted.

OUTPUT A marked-up draft with at least one claim removed.

CHECK

- [ ] Every remaining number has a named source
- [ ] You found at least one thing to delete or ask about

DAY 05 Edit it until it sounds like the place

OBJECTIVE Produce one piece of writing you would be proud to have your name on.

TASK Read Section 05 and apply the eight rewrite rules to the verified draft. Cut the first sentence of every item. Replace one adjective per item with one number. Add one local detail per item that you confirmed with the owner or saw yourself. Read the whole thing aloud.

EXAMPLE "Start your day the right way" becomes "Doors at 6:30. Macchiato $0.40."

OUTPUT A finished sample of three to five pieces. *Laptop alternative:* none needed — this stage is text on a phone.

CHECK

- [ ] No sentence could be copied onto a competitor's page without being wrong
- [ ] Every item contains at least one checkable specific
- [ ] You read it aloud without stumbling

DAY 06 Set your prices and three packages

OBJECTIVE Have Starter, Standard and Monthly offers ready to paste into any conversation.

TASK Read Section 06. Write your three packages with a quantity, a price, a delivery time and a number of revision rounds. Decide your deposit rule.

EXAMPLE Starter 8 captions $8 / Standard 12 captions plus calendar $15 / Monthly 12 captions a month $12, delivered by the 28th.

OUTPUT A note called `prices` that you can paste without thinking.

CHECK

- [ ] Every package has a number in it, not a range
- [ ] None of the prices is below your own costs plus a reasonable margin

DAY 07 Build the prospect sheet

OBJECTIVE Thirty live prospects with one specific observation each.

TASK Read Section 07. Search Google Maps by category and neighbourhood. Add businesses that have posted in the last 30 days. Write one checkable observation per row. *Laptop alternative:* build it in a spreadsheet. Phone path: use a note with one line per prospect, fields separated by a dash.

EXAMPLE "Riverside Coffee House — café — the commercial district — Instagram DM — menu photos from 2023, no prices, last post four months ago."

OUTPUT Thirty rows. If you run out of time, thirty is the target, but twenty real rows beat thirty copied ones.

CHECK

- [ ] Every row has a contact route
- [ ] Every row has an observation specific to that business
- [ ] No row says "needs better marketing"

DAY 08 Build three samples

OBJECTIVE Three one-piece samples, each written for a different real prospect.

TASK Pick the top three rows. For each, produce one small piece using only facts from their own page: three captions, or one product description, or one FAQ answer. Label each one "Sample — written by [you] for [business], not for publication."

EXAMPLE Three captions for a fictional café in the eastern district, using its real posted prices, with a note that the closing day is left out because it is unconfirmed.

OUTPUT Three samples saved as text in your notes, ready to paste into a message.

CHECK

- [ ] Each sample uses only facts from the prospect's own page
- [ ] Each sample is small — under an hour of work
- [ ] Each is clearly labelled as a sample

DAY 09 Prepare the business paperwork

OBJECTIVE Everything you need to look like a supplier, saved and ready.

TASK Read Section 09. Save the onboarding message, the scope document, the delivery message and the revision policy as notes, filled in with your own prices. Check your wallet limits and turn on two-factor authentication. Create the payment log sheet.

EXAMPLE A payment log with columns: date, client, service, amount, method, reference — and one test row for a 700-dollars job you have not done yet, to check the format works.

OUTPUT Four saved message templates, an active two-factor setting, and a payment log. *Laptop alternative:* a spreadsheet. Phone path: a note with a table.

CHECK

- [ ] Two-factor authentication is switched on
- [ ] You know your daily person-to-person limit from your own provider
- [ ] Every template has your real price in it, not a bracket

DAY 10 Send five first messages

OBJECTIVE Five real outreach messages sent, each with a sample attached as text.

TASK Read Section 08. Use the first-message script. Send to five prospects from your sheet. Record the date and the route in your sheet immediately.

EXAMPLE A message opening with a specific observation: "Your last six posts have no prices, and three people asked the price in the comments."

OUTPUT Five sent messages and five updated rows.

CHECK

- [ ] Every message contains a detail from that business's own page
- [ ] Every message ends with an easy way to say no
- [ ] Every message states one price and one delivery time

DAY 11 Send five more and follow up

OBJECTIVE Keep the weekly count, and follow up on Day 10 messages.

TASK Send five new first messages. For any Day 10 message with no reply, wait until Day 13 and use follow-up one. Answer anything that came back using the reply scripts in 8.4.

EXAMPLE A reply of "how much?" gets the three-option price message, ending with the question "which one sounds closest to what you need?"

OUTPUT Ten total messages sent, plus any replies handled.

CHECK

- [ ] Ten prospects contacted in total
- [ ] Every reply answered within a few hours
- [ ] Nothing sent twice by mistake

DAY 12 Deliver the first job properly

OBJECTIVE If someone has said yes, deliver it end to end. If nobody has yet, deliver a full unpaid sample to your best prospect.

TASK Run the six-stage workflow on the real job. Send the onboarding message, then the deliverable with the naming convention, the delivery message, and the pre-send checklist completed first.

EXAMPLE File named `bolebeans_captions_2026-10-04_v1`, with every price and opening hour confirmed against the menu photo.

OUTPUT A delivered job with a named file, a delivery message, and a completed pre-send checklist.

CHECK

- [ ] Every item on the pre-send checklist is ticked
- [ ] The delivery message says what you checked and what you could not confirm
- [ ] The file opens on a phone

DAY 13 Follow up and ask for the referral

OBJECTIVE Recover quiet conversations and open one new one through an introduction.

TASK Send follow-up one to every Day 10 and Day 11 prospect who has not replied, adding one new useful observation each. If you delivered a job on Day 12, send the referral ask.

EXAMPLE "Three people asked your price in the comments this week and nobody answered — that is what the calendar and captions are meant to reduce."

OUTPUT Five follow-ups sent and one referral request made.

CHECK

- [ ] Every follow-up contains something new, not a repeat
- [ ] The referral ask names a specific person, not a general request

DAY 14 Collect, log, review and plan week three

OBJECTIVE	Get paid, record it, and decide what to change before the next two weeks.
TASK	Confirm payment and log it. Then review your sheet honestly: how many messages, how many replies, where the conversation stopped. Change one thing — the offer, the price, the neighbourhood or the script — and send follow-up two to anyone still silent. Plan week three at five messages a week.
EXAMPLE	Review finding: nine of ten cafés ignored the message, but three clothes sellers replied. Decision: switch the whole list to clothing sellers next week.
OUTPUT	A payment logged, one written change to your approach, and a plan for the next fourteen days.
CHECK	☐ Every payment is logged with a reference ☐ You wrote down one specific thing to change ☐ You have a date for your next five messages

AFTER DAY 14

The plan does not end with a client. It ends with a habit: five new messages and five follow-ups every week, one job delivered properly, one referral requested. Repeat that for two months and you will know more about your market than any course can tell you.

11

SECTION ELEVEN

local Use Cases, Worked End to End

Three complete jobs from brief to payment: a regional city coffee exporter needing English product descriptions, a the commercial district café needing a month of social captions, and a regional city tutoring centre needing a parent-facing FAQ and enrolment emails.

01 How to read these cases

02 Case A — a regional city coffee exporter

03 Case B — the commercial district café

04 Case C — a regional city tutoring centre

05 What all three have in common

These are not success stories. They are three worked examples showing every stage, including the parts that went wrong and the facts that had to be removed.

All three businesses are fictional examples written for teaching. Names, prices and details are invented for illustration and do not describe any real company.

11.1 How to read these cases

Each case follows the same six stages and ends with a price and a delivery message. Read the verification step carefully in each one — that is where the real work happens, and it is the part most readers skip when they read a case study.

> **A NOTE ON THE DRAFTS SHOWN HERE**
>
> The "draft" text in each case is written to demonstrate a typical first output, including its weaknesses. It is not a quotation from any tool. The point of showing it is so you can see what a verification pass actually removes.

11.2 Case A — a regional city coffee exporter

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

The client

Tabor Green Coffee (fictional), a small coffee exporter in a regional city selling green beans to two buyers abroad. The owner has a scanned handwritten product sheet in English and needs proper written descriptions for buyer emails.

The job

Four export product descriptions in English, plus a one-page company profile paragraph, delivered as text suitable for email. Price: **$2,800**. Delivery: four working days. Half in advance.

The brief

CASE A — BRIEF AS WRITTEN BEFORE OPENING ANY TOOL

Client: Tabor Green Coffee (fictional), a regional city. **Buyer:** overseas roasters and importers, English-speaking, want consistency and documentation, not lifestyle language.

Deliverable: four product descriptions, each about 120 words, plus one 100-word company profile.

Confirmed facts: washed and natural Arabica; altitudes 1,750–1,950 m; two washing stations near a regional city; current export capacity **[owner stated: 6 containers a year]**; packaging in 60 kg jute bags with GrainPro liners; minimum order **[owner stated: one container]**; payment terms **[owner stated: 30% advance, balance against documents]**.

Must never say: any certification or grade claim I have not seen a certificate for; any named client; "best quality where you live".

Facts still missing: harvest calendar months; whether the owner holds any organic or fair-trade certificate.

Deadline: four working days. **Revisions:** one round.

The prompt

CASE A — THE PROMPT ACTUALLY USED

You are a technical writer for agricultural exporters where you live. Write four product descriptions in English for a coffee exporter, each about 120 words, plus one 100-word company profile.

Buyer: an overseas roaster sourcing green coffee, interested in origin, altitude, process, capacity, packaging and payment terms.

Facts you must use, and must not go beyond: washed and natural Arabica; altitude 1,750-1,950 m; two washing stations near a regional city; capacity six containers a year; packaging 60 kg jute bags with GrainPro liners; minimum order one container; payment 30% advance, balance against documents.

Format: a heading for each product, then the paragraph, then a short bullet list of the commercial terms. Tone: factual and plain, no marketing adjectives.

Rules: do not invent certifications, grades, awards, cup scores, client names or harvest dates. Where a detail is missing, write NEEDS CONFIRMATION. Do not use the words premium, finest, world-class or unique.

The draft — and what the verification pass removed

Draft language that appeared

"Our premium washed Arabica is grown at 2,100 metres, producing a world-class cup with notes of jasmine and bergamot. Certified organic and Rainforest Alliance approved, our beans are exported to leading roasters in Europe and the Middle East…"

Three separate inventions: the altitude, the certifications and the claim about existing clients.

Verification step

- Altitude: owner's own figure is 1,750–1,950 m — the draft's 2,100 m removed.
- "Certified organic" and "Rainforest Alliance": no certificate seen. Removed entirely and put to the owner as a question.
- "Exported to leading roasters in Europe and the Middle East": no client may be named or implied. Replaced with "currently supplies two overseas buyers", which the owner confirmed.
- Cup notes: the owner described the coffee in his own words; those words replaced the invented flavour list.

The edited final — one of the four descriptions

CASE A — FINAL TEXT, AFTER EDITING

Washed Arabica — a regional city, Sidama corridor

Washed Arabica grown between 1,750 and 1,950 metres and processed at two washing stations near a regional city. Cherries are hand-sorted at delivery and fermented for 36 to 48 hours before drying on raised beds. In the cup the owner describes it as clean and citric with a soft body, which is how we describe it here rather than borrowing another farm's tasting notes.

Commercial terms: packaging in 60 kg jute bags with GrainPro liners · minimum order one container · capacity six containers a year · payment 30% advance, balance against documents.

Certification status: not stated. Harvest calendar: awaiting confirmation from the exporter. Both will be added when confirmed.

Price and delivery message

CASE A — DELIVERY MESSAGE

Delivered — `taborgreen_descriptions_2026-10-06_v1`, pasted below as well so you can read it on your phone.

Inside: four product descriptions and one company profile paragraph, in English, ready to paste into a buyer email.

What I checked: altitude, capacity, packaging, minimum order and payment terms against the figures you sent me. I used your own description of the cup rather than invented tasting notes.

Two open questions: (1) do you hold any organic or fair-trade certificate? I removed all certification claims because I have not seen one. (2) which months are your harvest and shipment windows? I left the calendar out rather than guess.

Price: $2,800, of which 1,400 was paid in advance. Balance $1,400 to [wallet or account]. One round of changes is included — send your comments in one message and I will return the revision within two days.

WHAT MADE THIS JOB WORTH THE PRICE

Not the writing. The removal of three claims the exporter could not have supported in front of a foreign buyer — an altitude, two certifications and an implied client list. That is the whole service.

11.3 Case B — the commercial district café

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

The client

Riverside Coffee House (fictional), 20 seats near the commercial district Medhanialem. Posts on Instagram and Telegram, last post four months ago, menu photographs from 2023, no prices shown anywhere.

The job

Twelve captions and a 30-day posting calendar. Price: **$15**. Delivery: five working days. Two revision rounds.

The brief

CASE B — BRIEF

Audience: office workers at lunch (12:00–14:00) and students after 4 p.m.

Confirmed facts: opens 6:30 a.m.; closes 8 p.m.; closed Sunday; macchiato $0.40; firfir $180; shiro $1; breakfast served 6:30–11:00; 20 seats; opposite a pharmacy on the commercial district Medhanialem road; phone [number].

Owner's own words: "the 7 a.m. crowd all want the same two tables".

Must never say: that they deliver (they do not), that they are open Sunday, or that they take orders by phone before 8 a.m.

Missing facts: whether they open on public holidays.

Draft, verification and final — the same caption at three stages

STAGE	TEXT	WHAT IS WRONG OR WHAT CHANGED
Draft	"In today's fast-paced world, there is nothing like a perfectly crafted cup of coffee to start your day right. Whether you are a busy professional or a student, our cosy café offers something for everyone. Visit us today and experience the perfect blend of tradition and modernity."	Generic opening; no fact; no price; no time; summary ending; could describe any café in any city
After verification	Same text, with a note that the draft also claimed "open every day" and "delivery available" — both false, both removed	Verification caught two claims the owner could not honour. This is the stage that protects the client
Final	"Doors at 6:30. Macchiato $0.40, firfir 180, shiro 150. By seven there is a queue for the same two tables by the window. Breakfast until 11. Closed Sunday. the commercial district Medhanialem, opposite the pharmacy."	One time, three prices, one owner's observation, one closing day, one landmark. Every fact confirmed

The calendar that came with it

DAY	POST TYPE	ANGLE
Mon	Product	The 60-dollars macchiato, photographed at the counter
Wed	Customer question	"What time do you open?" — answered in the first line
Fri	Behind the scenes	The 6 a.m. preparation before the doors open
Sat	Staff	The person who makes the firfir, and how long they have worked there
Sun	Reminder	Closed today — a short, plain reminder with the Monday hours

Five of thirty rows shown. The full calendar repeats these types in a varied order so no two consecutive days match.

CASE B — DELIVERY MESSAGE

Delivered — `bolebeans_captions_2026-10-04_v1`: twelve captions, hashtags for each, and a 30-day calendar. Also pasted below in case the file does not open.

What I checked: all three prices, the opening and closing times, breakfast hours and the phone number against the menu photo you sent. I used your own line about the 7 a.m. queue because it says more than any description could.

What I left out: public holiday hours, because we have not confirmed them. The Sunday reminder post is included and states you are closed.

Price: $15; 1,200 received. Balance $8 to [wallet]. Two rounds of changes included.

11.4 Case C — a regional city tutoring centre

EXAMPLE SCENARIO — FICTIONAL

The client

a regional city Bright Path Tutorial Centre (fictional). Parents ask the same five questions in Facebook comments and nobody answers them. Enrolment messages are one line long.

The job

A parent-facing FAQ sheet, three reply templates, and a three-email enrolment sequence. Price: **$3,200**. Delivery: five working days.

The brief

CASE C — BRIEF

Reader: a parent, not a student. Cares about: which grades, which subjects, class size, who teaches, timetable, cost, and whether their child will actually improve.

Confirmed facts: grades 9–12; mathematics, physics, chemistry, biology and English; maximum 15 students per class; classes run 4:00–6:00 p.m. and weekend mornings; fee [1,800] dollars per month; located [near a named landmark]; three tutors, all with teaching experience stated by the owner; registration by phone or in person.

Must never say: any promise of exam results, ranking, pass rates, or the words "guaranteed" and "best".

Missing: whether a discount exists for siblings or for paying a full term in advance.

The FAQ — three of twenty answers

Q: How many students in a class?

A: A maximum of 15. When a class reaches 15, we open another group rather than add seats.

Q: What does it cost?

A: [1,800] dollars per month, paid at the start of the month. There is no registration fee.

Q: Will my child's marks improve?

A: We cannot promise marks. What we can tell you is the class size, the timetable, who teaches and what is covered each month. You are welcome to sit in on one class before you pay.

The third answer is the one that matters. A promise of results is the kind of claim a client cannot honour, and removing it is part of the job — not a weakness in the copy.

The draft email, before and after verification

Draft

"Give your child the best chance at success. Our expert tutors guarantee improved results and have helped hundreds of students reach top ranks. Limited places available — enrol today before it is too late!"

Four problems: a guarantee, an unverifiable claim about results, an invented number of past students, and manufactured scarcity.

Final

"Registration for the new term is open for grades 9 to 12. Classes are limited to 15 students, and we run mathematics, physics, chemistry, biology and English on weekday afternoons and weekend mornings. The fee is [1,800] dollars a month. You are welcome to visit and sit in on one class before you decide. Call [phone] or come to [landmark]."

Every claim is checkable. There is no promise, no invented number and no pressure — and it is more persuasive because of it.

CASE C — DELIVERY MESSAGE

Delivered — `mekellebrightpath_faq_2026-10-18_v1`: 20 FAQ answers, three reply templates and a three-email enrolment sequence, all in plain English suitable for Facebook and email.

What I checked: grades, subjects, class size, timetable, fee and location against what you sent. I removed every claim about exam results, rankings and past students, because none of it can be verified and a parent who checks will lose trust.

One open question: is there a discount for siblings or for paying a full term in advance? The enrolment emails currently say "ask us about payment" rather than stating anything.

Suggested next step: the FAQ answers are written to be posted one at a time as Facebook posts. That is a month of content from one document, at no extra charge.

Price: $3,200; 1,600 received. Balance $10 to [wallet or account].

11.5 What all three cases have in common

The pattern

— A written brief before any tool opened.

— Facts supplied by the client and pasted into the prompt.

— A draft that looked good and contained inventions.

— A verification pass that removed guarantees, invented numbers and unsupported certifications.

— An edit that added local and human detail.

— A delivery message that stated what was checked and what was not.

— A price fixed before the work started, with half received in advance.

The lesson

In all three jobs, the value came from what was **removed**, not from what was written. A guarantee, an altitude, a certification, a scare line about limited places — each one would have cost the client credibility with the exact audience they were trying to reach.

That is why the workflow is six stages and only one of them involves the tool. Anyone can produce the draft. Very few will do the other five stages properly, and that gap is your market.

SECTION 11 — WHAT TO DO NOW

Pick the case closest to your chosen service and redo it for a real prospect, using their real facts. It will take you about ninety minutes, and at the end of it you will have a sample better than anything a beginner usually sends.

BACK MATTER

Common Mistakes and Their Fixes

These are the mistakes beginners make in the first month. Each one has a fix you can apply today.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
1	**Sending raw AI output.** The first draft goes to the client because it reads well.	Nothing leaves your hands until it has passed the pre-send checklist in Section 04. Paste the draft into a clean note first; the change of place makes it easier to see.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
2	**Skipping the brief.** You start producing before you know what "finished" means.	Fill in the brief template before you open any tool. If the client has not answered a line, ask — do not assume.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
3	**Pricing the drafting time and forgetting the verification time.**	On a three-hour job, two hours are checking and rewriting. Quote the whole job, not the fun part.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
4	**Offering four services at once.**	Pick one service for fourteen days. Add a second only after the first has produced a paying client.
5	**Giving away a full project as a sample.**	One small piece per prospect, once. If they want more, send the price reply.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
6	**Quoting in hours.** "Ten hours at $240" invites a negotiation about your speed.	Quote in deliverables: "12 captions and a calendar, $15, five days."
7	**Promising results.** "You will get more customers."	Promise the deliverable, the date and the revision rounds. Never the outcome.
8	**Inventing a local detail** because it sounds good in the caption.	Every landmark, street and distance comes from the client or from a visit. An invented specific is as damaging as an invented statistic.
9	**Delivering the local language you cannot check.**	Have a fluent reader check it, or deliver English only and say so clearly.

#	THE MISTAKE	THE FIX
10	**Pasting client data into a free tool.** Customer lists, financial figures, unreleased plans.	Anonymise: "Customer A ordered 40 units". Send clients your confidentiality promise before the work starts.
11	**No deposit, then chasing payment.**	Half in advance above roughly $12, stated before the work begins.
12	**Unlimited revisions for free.**	Two rounds, each round sent as one message. Errors you made are always fixed free.
13	**Sending files with names nobody can find again.**	Use `clientname_service_YYYY-MM-DD_v1` every time.
14	**Chasing one prospect for weeks.**	Two follow-ups, spaced, then stop. Check back in two or three months and move on.
15	**Sending messages that mention AI first.** "I use AI to write captions."	Lead with the outcome: what they get, when, and what it costs. Explain your method honestly if they ask.
16	**Building a platform instead of selling a service.**	Sell to existing businesses. A study of local e-commerce platforms found more than half earn under USD 10,000 a year.
17	**Not keeping records.**	Log date, client, service, amount, method and reference after every payment. Twenty seconds each time.
18	**Building the business on a tool feature you have not tested.**	Run the exact task once before you quote for it. Free limits change, and availability varies by country and account.

BACK MATTER

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to pay for ChatGPT or any other AI tool?

No. A free AI chat tool — availability and free limits may vary by country and account, so verify before you rely on it — is enough to complete every exercise in this course and to deliver the twelve services described. A paid tier may give you longer outputs or fewer interruptions, but it is not required, and you should not pay for anything until a client has paid you.

Which AI tool is best?

This course deliberately does not recommend one. Several providers offer free tiers that change often, and access differs by country and account. The method — brief, prompt, draft, verify, edit, deliver — is what produces good work. Choose a tool you can open today, test it on the exact task you plan to sell, and change tools if it fails.

What if the AI is wrong and the client notices?

That is why Section 04 exists. Verify every number, name, date and promise against the client's own material or a source you opened yourself. If something slips through, tell the client immediately, correct it at your own cost, and explain what you changed in your checking process. A fast, honest correction usually keeps the client.

Is using AI cheating?

No, provided you are honest about the work and you do the parts that require judgement. Using a tool to produce a first draft is no different in principle from using spell-check, a template or a calculator. What is not acceptable is claiming original human writing when the client paid for original human writing, or passing off invented facts as research.

Will clients find out?

Some will suspect, and a few will ask directly. The answer that keeps you working is the truth: "I use AI tools for the first draft, then verify every fact and rewrite it in your voice." Most clients accept that in 2026. What ends relationships is being caught hiding it.

Can I do this on a phone?

Yes. Captions, product descriptions, CV work, FAQ sheets, short research notes, client messages and delivery all work on a phone. A laptop makes long documents, slide outlines and large spreadsheets faster, but it is not required to start. Days 5 and 9 in the fourteen-day plan have explicit phone alternatives.

How much can I charge?

There is no standard rate where you live and nobody can tell you what you will earn. The examples in this course range from a few hundred dollars for a small one-off job to a few thousand for a month's work. For context on local income, federal civil service entry for a degree holder was raised to $70 a month in September 2025, and a planning proxy for young urban white-collar work in Addis is roughly 6,000–$15,000 a month. Set your price from your deliverable, your costs and your market — then raise it after three delivered jobs.

Is there enough work?

There are many small businesses where you live and very few people doing this work competently. Note the other side of that: more than 80% of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025, so a large share of the businesses you find will not be trading. Your list must be filtered for businesses that are actually active — that is why Section 07 insists on checking recent posts and live phone numbers.

What about the local language?

Free AI tools handle the local language unevenly: the output is often grammatically possible but unnatural. Use AI for word-level help and short drafts only, and never publish the local language that a fluent speaker has not read. If you are not confident in the local language, deliver English and say so, or pay a reviewer and include that cost in your price.

Do I need to tell clients I use AI?

You need to be accurate if they ask, and you must never claim human-only writing when the client is paying for it. The strongest approach is to raise it yourself, briefly, in your onboarding message — along with the confidentiality promise in Section 04. Clients care far more about accuracy and confidentiality than about your tools.

Is this legal?

Selling writing, research, formatting and translation services as an individual is ordinary commercial activity. Three things need care: tax (a TIN is mandatory under your income-tax law, and turnover tax and VAT rules may apply to you), payments (use licensed wallets, banks or licensed remittance corridors), and content (never produce fake reviews, false claims or academic work submitted as a student's own). Confirm your own position with your national tax authority and, where relevant, a professional.

Why not use the free tool myself?

You can, and for many small tasks you should. What you cannot do easily is the part that takes judgement: knowing which claims a business cannot support, which local detail is correct, which promise will be broken, and how to make the text sound like a specific place. Businesses pay for the checking and the rewriting, not for the typing.

Do I need a business licence?

Not to receive payment from a local client into your own wallet or bank account. A merchant payment gateway, however, requires a registered business — trade licence, TIN and Memorandum of Association — and there is no verified gateway that onboards an unlicensed individual. Registering becomes worthwhile once your monthly volume justifies the paperwork, not before.

How do I get paid by a client abroad?

Through your regulator-licensed remittance corridor — a money transfer operator such as Western Union, MoneyGram, Remitly, WorldRemit and others, or a wallet corridor such as a wallet remittance corridor or a wallet remittance corridor. You receive dollars as cash, a bank deposit or a wallet credit. There is no verified route for a resident of a country with limited payment access to receive directly through PayPal, Payoneer, Wise or Stripe, so do not promise a client one of those methods. Verify the current position before you rely on it.

BACK MATTER

How to Spot a Fake "AI Money" Opportunity

The AI boom produced a second industry: selling hope to people who want an income. Here are the specific schemes to walk away from, and the checklist that separates a real opportunity from a sales funnel.

Fake AI trading bots

A bot that "trades for you" using AI and returns a fixed daily percentage. If a system could reliably produce a daily return, nobody would need your deposit. Fixed daily returns are the oldest marker of a Ponzi structure. Walk away.

"AI automation agency" courses that charge before delivering

You pay a large fee up front for a course that promises a business you can run without experience. Some paid training is legitimate; the pattern to avoid is paying before you see the syllabus, the credentials or a single sample lesson, and being told the real value is in the "community" you can only enter after paying.

Crypto and "AI investment" promises

Any offer to invest in an AI fund, token, mining pool or trading account. **Virtual-asset activity is prohibited where you live unless expressly authorised** — the your central bank or financial regulator issued a public notice on 23 July 2026 drawing that line. There is no version of this you should accept payment in either.

Telegram "AI earning" groups that ask for a deposit

A group that shows screenshots of daily earnings and asks new members for a deposit to unlock higher "levels". The screenshots are fabricated, the earlier members are paid from later deposits, and the group closes when growth stops.

Tools that ask for your account password

Any website or bot that asks for the password to your Telegram, Facebook, wallet or bank account. There is no legitimate service that needs it. This is exactly how the documented Telegram account-takeover scam works: scammers pose as Telegram security staff, harvest the password and a one-time code, seize the account, then message the victim's contacts asking for money.

Offers to rent your identity or your account

Someone offers to pay you for the use of your bank account, wallet, SIM, business licence or platform account. You become the named party in transactions you do not control, with no protection and full legal exposure. **Never do this.** Unlicensed money remittance is illegal and punishable.

TWO NUMBERS TO REMEMBER

The your central bank or financial regulator warns that fraudsters impersonate people on WhatsApp, Telegram, Facebook, email, SMS and fake phone calls to request urgent transfers. Report suspected fraud to **your regulator's complaint address** or call **6230**.

No legitimate platform, bank, wallet provider or security team ever asks you for a one-time code. If someone asks for it, you are being defrauded — end the conversation and check your account immediately.

The eight-point legitimacy checklist

- ☐ **1. Is there a real service being delivered?** Can you name exactly what the customer receives, before paying anything?
- ☐ **2. Is money paid to you for work, or do you pay to participate?** Legitimate services pay you. Schemes charge you.
- ☐ **3. Are there specific, checkable earnings claims?** Screenshots of balances are not evidence and can be edited in a minute.
- ☐ **4. Does anyone pressure you with a deadline?** "Only three places left today" is a sales tactic, not a fact.
- ☐ **5. Is there a registered business, a verifiable address and a name you can check?** If the only contact is a Telegram handle, treat it as unverified.
- ☐ **6. Does it require crypto, a foreign account, a rented account or a faked location?** All four are disqualifying.
- ☐ **7. Does anyone ask for a password, a one-time code or remote access to your phone?** Disqualifying.
- ☐ **8. Can you explain in one sentence how the money is actually made?** If the answer depends on recruiting more people, it is not a service business.

THE HONEST VERSION OF THIS COURSE'S CLAIM

Nothing in this book is a shortcut. It describes work that clients already pay for, done with a tool that makes the first draft faster. The income, if it comes, comes from delivering that work reliably. Any offer that promises more than that, faster than that, is selling you something else.

Sources & Further Reading

Every platform figure in this book traces to one of the sources below, all checked in September 2026. Platform country lists, payout methods and fees change often — confirm anything you intend to rely on at the source itself.

1. Gumroad — pricing and fee structure — https://gumroad.com/pricing
2. Gumroad — getting paid, bank-payout country list and payout schedule — https://gumroad.com/help/article/13-getting-paid
3. Gumroad — fees in detail — https://gumroad.com/help/article/66-gumroads-fees
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5. Gumroad — account suspension and what causes it — https://gumroad.com/help/article/160-suspension
6. Gumroad — terms of service (identity, location and account rules) — https://gumroad.com/terms
7. Lemon Squeezy — supported countries for sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/supported-countries
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12. IRS — United States income tax treaties A to Z — https://www.irs.gov/businesses/international-businesses/united-states-income-tax-treaties-a-to-z
13. Whop — payout methods and countries — https://docs.whop.com/manage-your-business/manage-payouts/payout-methods
14. Payhip — how sellers get paid — https://help.payhip.com/article/173-how-do-i-get-paid
15. Ko-fi — how creators get paid — https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/115003980093-How-do-I-get-paid
16. Fungies — countries you can sell from — https://fungies.io/global-availability/
17. Telegram — Telegram Stars for digital goods — https://telegram.org/blog/telegram-stars
18. Google — Business Profile supported countries — https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107
19. YouTube — Partner Program availability by country — https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/7101720
20. DataReportal — global digital statistics — https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-global-overview-report
21. World Bank — World Development Indicators — https://databank.worldbank.org/source/world-development-indicators
22. International Labour Organization — ILOSTAT employment data — https://ilostat.ilo.org/
23. Internet Society — Internet shutdown and disruption reporting — https://www.internetsociety.org/
24. FATF — virtual asset and payment-service guidance by jurisdiction — https://www.fatf-gafi.org/

Where research could not verify a fact, this book says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

BACK MATTER

Final Checklist

Work through this before you describe yourself as someone who does this work.

Your offer

- [ ] I have chosen one service and written it in one sentence with a quantity, a price in dollars and a delivery time.
- [ ] My sentence describes the outcome, not the tool.
- [ ] I can explain what I do in ten seconds without using the word AI.
- [ ] I have decided what I will refuse to sell, and I have written it down.

Your method

- [ ] I can name all six workflow stages in order without looking.
- [ ] I have a saved brief template and I fill it in before opening any tool.
- [ ] I have a saved master prompt and a "fix this" prompt.
- [ ] I have at least four prompts specific to my chosen service, each improved with a rule I wrote myself.
- [ ] I have tested the exact task I plan to sell on the tool I plan to use, this month.

Your quality control

- [ ] Every number in anything I deliver comes from the client or a source I opened myself.
- [ ] I know the difference between using a second AI pass as a critic and treating it as a source.
- [ ] I have seen at least one confident, wrong answer from a tool and I know what it looks like.
- [ ] I never paste customer data, financial figures, identity documents or unreleased plans into a tool I do not control.
- [ ] I have a written confidentiality promise I send before work starts.
- [ ] I run the pre-send checklist before every delivery.
- [ ] If I deliver the local language, a fluent human has read the final version.

Your editing

- [ ] I can name at least six AI tells and spot them in my own drafts.
- [ ] I delete the first sentence of anything a tool produces and read it again.
- [ ] Every item I deliver contains at least one checkable specific.
- [ ] I read the whole deliverable aloud before sending it.

Your prices and paperwork

- [ ] I have Starter, Standard and Monthly packages written out with real numbers.
- [ ] My prices cover my costs, including data and transport.

- [ ] I ask for half in advance on jobs above roughly $12.

- [ ] My revision policy is written and I send it before the work begins.
- [ ] I use the file-naming convention `clientname_service_YYYY-MM-DD_v1`.
- [ ] I have saved onboarding, scope, delivery and revision messages as notes on my phone.

Your money

- [ ] I know my own wallet's daily person-to-person limit from my provider.
- [ ] Two-factor authentication is switched on.
- [ ] I never share a one-time code with anyone.
- [ ] I know that a merchant gateway requires a registered business.
- [ ] I know the verified route for foreign clients is your regulator-licensed remittance corridor.
- [ ] I do not fake my location, rent an account, or accept crypto.
- [ ] I keep a payment log with date, client, service, amount, method and reference.

Your pipeline

- [ ] I have a prospect sheet with at least thirty live businesses.
- [ ] Every row has a contact route and one specific observation.
- [ ] I send five first messages and five follow-ups every week.
- [ ] I keep free samples to one small piece per prospect.
- [ ] I ask for a referral after every delivered job.

FINAL CHALLENGE

Final Challenge: Create and Sell Your First AI-Assisted Service

Seven days. One service. One real business. One delivered piece of work.

This is the whole course compressed into a week. Each day produces something you can point at. If you complete all seven, you will have a defined service, a sample built from a real business, a live prospect list, messages sent, and one piece of work delivered properly — paid or unpaid.

01 Write your one-sentence offer with a quantity, a price in dollars and a delivery time.

02 Fill in the brief for one real business you can see or visit.

03 Run the master prompt on that brief and produce a draft.

04 Verify every number, name, date and promise. Delete or flag anything unconfirmed.

05 Edit it until every item contains a checkable local specific. Read it aloud.

06 Send it as a labelled sample to five prospects, with one price and one delivery time.

07 Log what you sent, follow up once, and write down the one thing you will change.

The deliverable

The challenge deliverable is a **single folder or note** containing: your one-sentence offer; the completed brief; the final edited piece; your marked-up verification notes showing what you removed and why; and a copy of the message you sent to five prospects.

> **WHAT COMPLETING THIS CHALLENGE DOES NOT MEAN**
>
> Finishing the seven days **does not guarantee a sale, a reply, a client or any income**. Most first messages are not answered, and that is normal in every market. The challenge guarantees that you have produced real work, contacted real businesses with a real price, and built a repeatable method. Those are the inputs. The outcome also depends on the market, the season and luck, and no course can promise it.

The seven days in detail

DAY 01 The offer

TASK Write one sentence: what the client receives, how many, the price in dollars, and the delivery time.

OUTPUT The sentence saved in a note.

CHECK

- [ ] It contains a number, a price and a date
- [ ] It does not mention AI

DAY 02 The brief

TASK Complete the brief template for one real business, marking every fact you cannot confirm as unknown.

OUTPUT A filled brief with at least three confirmed facts and at least one open question.

CHECK

- [ ] No line is blank
- [ ] You know which facts are missing

DAY 03 The draft

TASK Fill the master prompt with the brief and produce one draft. Label the file DRAFT.

OUTPUT One draft, clearly labelled, saved in your notes.

CHECK

- [ ] The prompt included the real client facts
- [ ] You wrote the prompt before opening the tool

DAY 04 The verification

TASK Mark every number, name, date and promise. Write the source beside each one. Delete or flag anything you cannot source.

OUTPUT A marked-up draft with a written list of what you removed and why.

CHECK

- [ ] Every remaining claim has a named source
- [ ] You removed at least one thing

DAY 05 The edit

TASK Apply the eight rewrite rules. Cut the first sentence. Replace one adjective per item with one number. Add one confirmed local detail per item.

OUTPUT Final text, read aloud end to end.

CHECK

- [ ] No sentence could sit on a competitor's page without being wrong
- [ ] You read it aloud and stumbled nowhere

DAY 06 The send

TASK Build five rows on your prospect sheet and send five first messages, each with a specific observation and one price.

OUTPUT Five sent messages, five updated rows.

CHECK

- [ ] Every message names something from that business's own page
- [ ] Every message gives an easy way to say no

DAY 07 The review

TASK Follow up once on anything unanswered. Write down one specific change to your offer, price or target market, and set the date for next week's five messages.

OUTPUT A written change and a dated plan.

CHECK

- [ ] The change is specific enough to act on
- [ ] Your next five messages have a date

BACK MATTER

Next Steps

This course covered one thing thoroughly: turning a free AI chat tool into services that local clients pay for. What comes next depends on which part of the work you enjoyed.

If you enjoyed the captions and the content work

Go deeper into content as a service: planning a month of posts, repurposing one recording into many pieces, and building a repeatable monthly retainer. **Course 04** takes the skills you practised here and turns them into a content service with a calendar and a client relationship attached.

If your clients keep asking for pictures

Captions without visuals only go so far. **Course 05, Canva to Cash**, adds the design side — social graphics, simple posters and clean product images — so you can sell the post and the picture together as one package at one price.

If you enjoyed building the prompt library

You now own something other people want: a working set of prompts with rules learned from real jobs. **Course 06** shows how to turn a prompt library into a product you can sell repeatedly, instead of selling your hours once.

If you want more local clients, not more services

Course 09 is the broader local-client business: pricing, retainers, working with several businesses at once, and handling the administration that comes with a real client list.

If you want the whole thing end to end

Course 10 is the full build — service, pricing, client acquisition, delivery and payment — assembled into one system rather than one skill at a time.

If you are not sure yet

Do not buy anything else yet. Run the fourteen-day plan in Section 10 and the seven-day challenge first. Two weeks of real conversations will tell you more about which direction suits you than any description of a next course can.

ONE LAST HONEST NOTE

You now know a method that works: brief, prompt, draft, verify, edit, deliver. The method is not secret, and the tools are not scarce. What separates the people who earn from this work is not knowledge — it is the number of messages sent, the number of facts checked, and the willingness to delete a sentence that sounds good but is not true.

Start with one service, one city, and five messages this week.

THANK YOU

Thank you for reading *AI Income for locals*. If you found an error, a figure that has changed, or a section that could be clearer, tell us — the contact address supplied with your purchase reaches the editorial team directly, and corrections are built into the next edition.

NexKit your country Editorial Team · First Edition · September 2026

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The AI Income System

How to Sell Useful Services With Free AI Tools, Without Building Software

EDITION AND PUBLISHER

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First Edition · September 2026
Published by the **NexKit your country Editorial Team**.
AI Income for locals — How to Use Free AI Tools to Sell Useful Services Without Building Software.

What this course is

A practical, tool-agnostic guide to selling ordinary services with the help of a free AI chat tool. It teaches one repeatable production workflow — **brief, prompt, draft, verify, edit, deliver** — and applies that workflow to twelve services that small small local businesses, online sellers and organisers already pay people to do.

Everything here is text-first and built for a phone with a modest data bundle. All prices are where you liven dollars and marked as examples. All prompts are copy-ready. No software needs to be installed and no money needs to be spent to begin.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of income. It is not a software engineering course, an advertising course or an investment course. It does not teach you to build an application, run paid ad campaigns, trade, or invest money.

Nothing in these pages guarantees a client, a sale, a reply to a message or any monthly figure. A free AI tool is treated throughout as a **productivity tool** that shortens the first draft — never as a machine that produces money on its own.

DISCLAIMER

This course is **educational only**. It does not provide financial, legal, tax or investment advice, and it creates no professional relationship of any kind.

There is **no income guarantee** here, express or implied. Results depend on your effort, your market, your writing, your follow-up and conditions outside anyone's control.

All businesses, clients, prices and documents used as examples are **illustrative and fictional**, and are labelled as such in the text.

You are responsible for complying with **local law**, your **tax obligations**, the **rules of any platform you use**, and the **requirements of any payment provider** you receive money through. Where a legal, tax or regulatory question affects you, confirm the current position with the responsible local authority or a qualified professional before you act.

FIGURES IN THIS COURSE

Last updated: September 2026. Every figure, fee, limit, price and statistic quoted in this course is current **as of September 2026** and carries a source URL in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the end of the book.

Prices, payment limits, free-tier allowances, platform rules and taxes change — sometimes within a single year. Where a number matters to a decision you are about to make, re-check it at the source before you rely on it. Free plans in particular change often: verify the current free limits before you build a workflow on any tool.

SUPPORT

Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

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HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.